Tradelink User Guide

Field	Value
Document	User Guide
Product	Tradelink, with Tradelink AI
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About this guide

Topic	Detail
Purpose	Help you complete everyday tasks in Tradelink, step by step.
Audience	Buyers (shops and food businesses), suppliers, and the Tradelink operations team. No technical knowledge is needed.
Scope	What the app does today. Features that are not available yet are named where you might look for them, so you are not left searching.

All businesses, people, products and amounts in the screenshots are fictional demo data.

Each task follows the same pattern: **What this is for**, **Before you start**, **Steps**, a screenshot, **What happens next** and **Common problems**. Numbered orange circles in a screenshot match the numbered notes under it.

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1. Welcome to Tradelink

What it does

Tradelink replaces ordering over WhatsApp and phone calls between small food businesses and their suppliers. In one app:

- **Buyers** order from all their suppliers, track deliveries, check what arrived and sort out problems.
- **Suppliers** receive orders, accept all or part of them, deliver them, keep stock up to date and answer problems.
- **The Tradelink operations team** (admins) watch for anything that needs attention, settle disputes and look after suppliers.

Tradelink AI is an assistant built into the app. You can ask it questions or tell it what to do in plain words, for example "add 2 packets of dried noodles to my cart". It always shows you what it is about to do and waits for you to tap a button before anything changes.

Who it is for

Role	Who they are	Main things they do
Buyer	A shop, kopitiam, bakery or restaurant that buys stock	Order, check deliveries, report problems, watch spending
Supplier	A business that sells to buyers	Accept and deliver orders, manage stock and prices, answer problems
Admin	The Tradelink operations team	Work through the attention queue, settle disputes, look after suppliers

Supported devices and browsers

Tradelink is a web app. You open it in a browser; there is nothing to download from an app store.

Device	What is supported
Laptop or desktop	Chrome is tested automatically. Screens of 760 pixels wide or more show the laptop layout.
Phone	Chrome on an Android phone is tested automatically (Pixel 7 size). Screens narrower than 760 pixels show the phone layout.
Other browsers	Up-to-date Safari, Edge and Firefox are not covered by automated tests.

You need an internet connection. Without one, Tradelink shows an offline page and you can try again when you are back online.

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2. Getting started

2.1 Sign in

What this is for: opening your Tradelink account.

Before you start: you need the email address and password for your account. Demo accounts share one password, which the project owner gives out privately.

Steps

1. Open Tradelink. You see the **Sign in** page.
2. Enter your **Email** and **Password**.
3. Select **Sign in**.

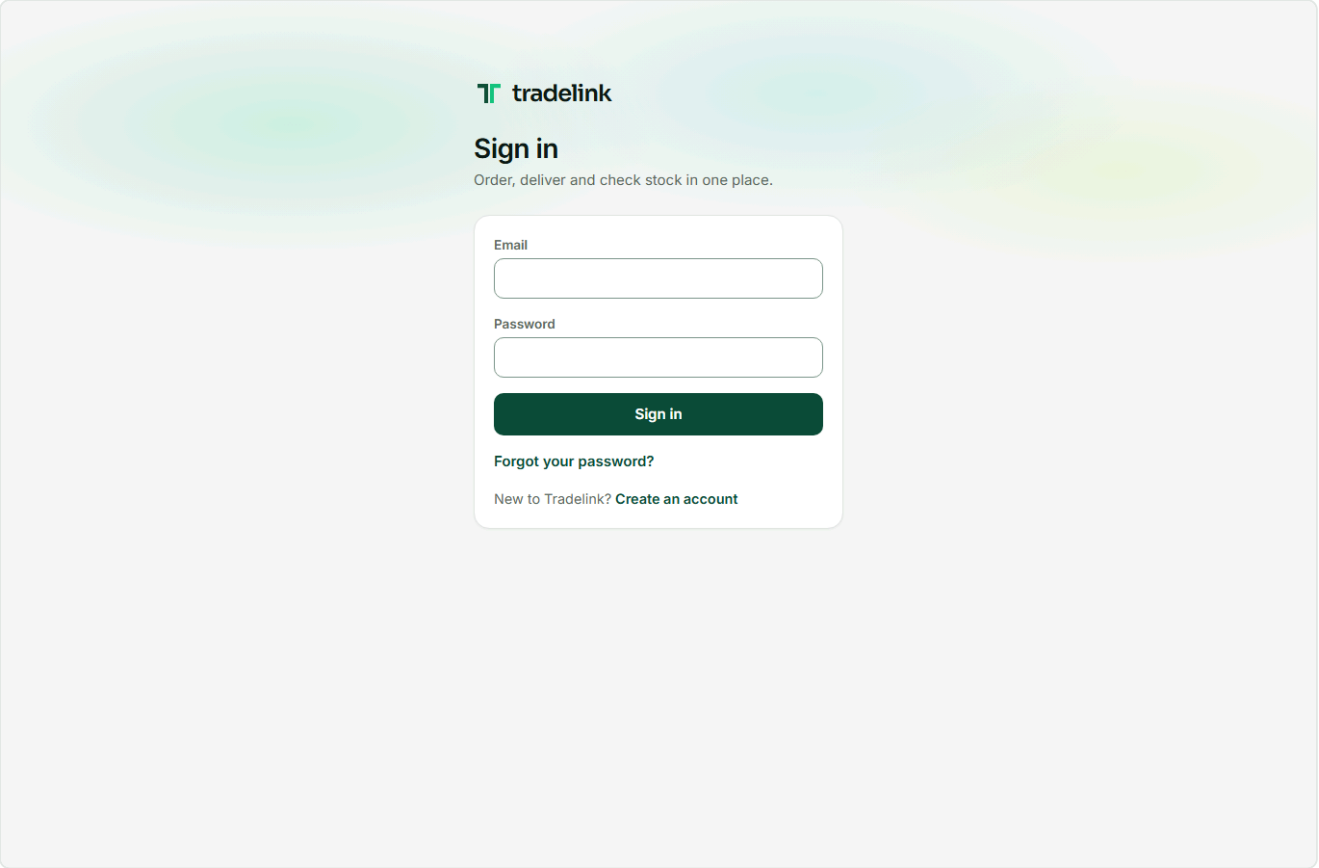


Figure 1. The sign-in page on a laptop.

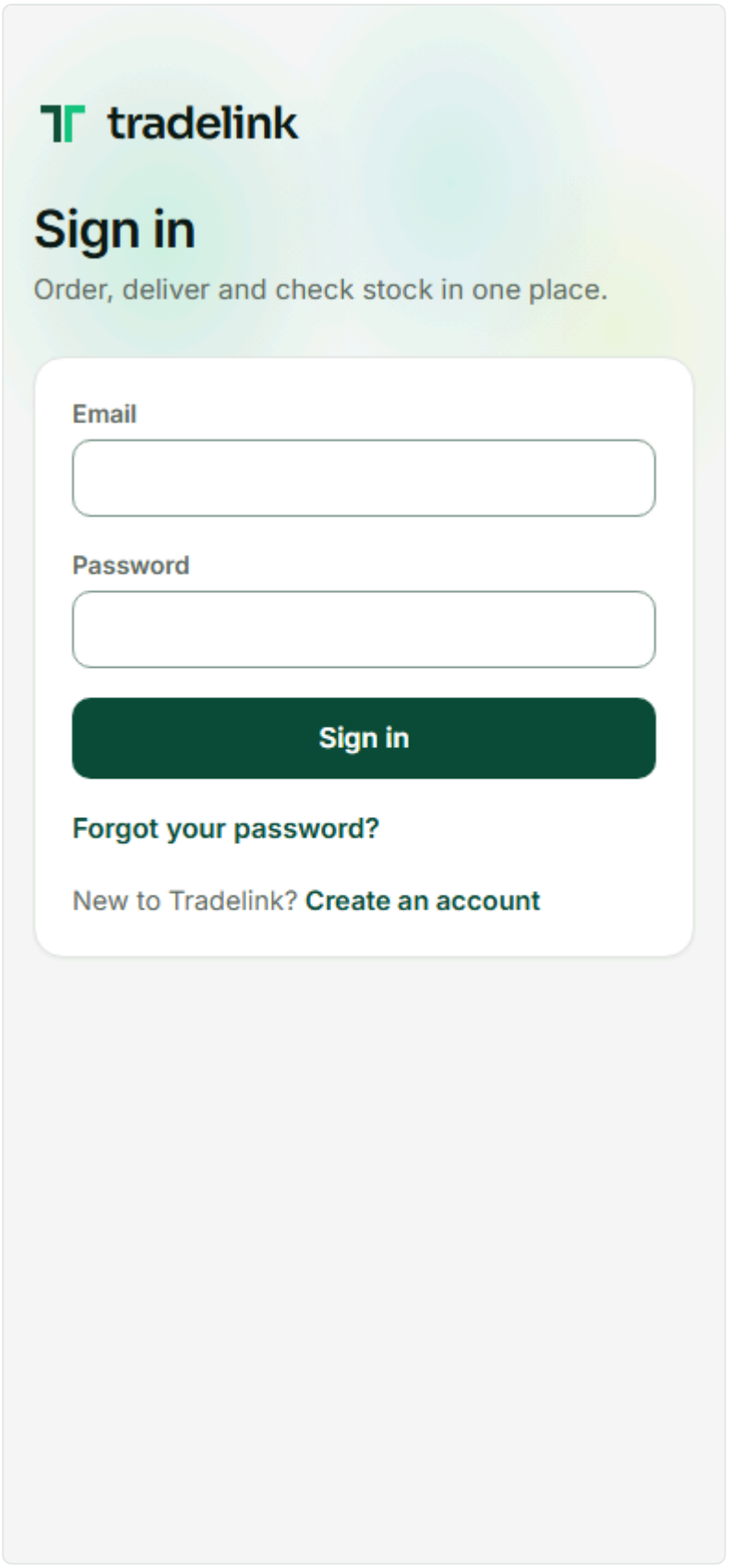


Figure 2. The same page on a phone.

What happens next: Tradelink opens the Home page for your role: buyer, supplier or admin. If you followed a link to a particular page, it opens that page.

Common problems

Message	What to do
"Check your email and password."	Check for typing mistakes, or reset your password (see 2.2).
"Too many attempts…"	Wait a few minutes before trying again.
"Confirm your email first…"	Open the confirmation email you were sent when you created the account.
A notice that a link has expired	Request a new link.

2.2 Reset a password

What this is for: choosing a new password when you have forgotten yours.

Before you start: you need access to the email inbox for your account.

Steps

1. On the sign-in page, select **Forgot your password?**
2. Enter your email address and send the request.
3. Open the email and select the link in it.
4. Enter a new password of at least 12 characters, enter it again to confirm, and save it.

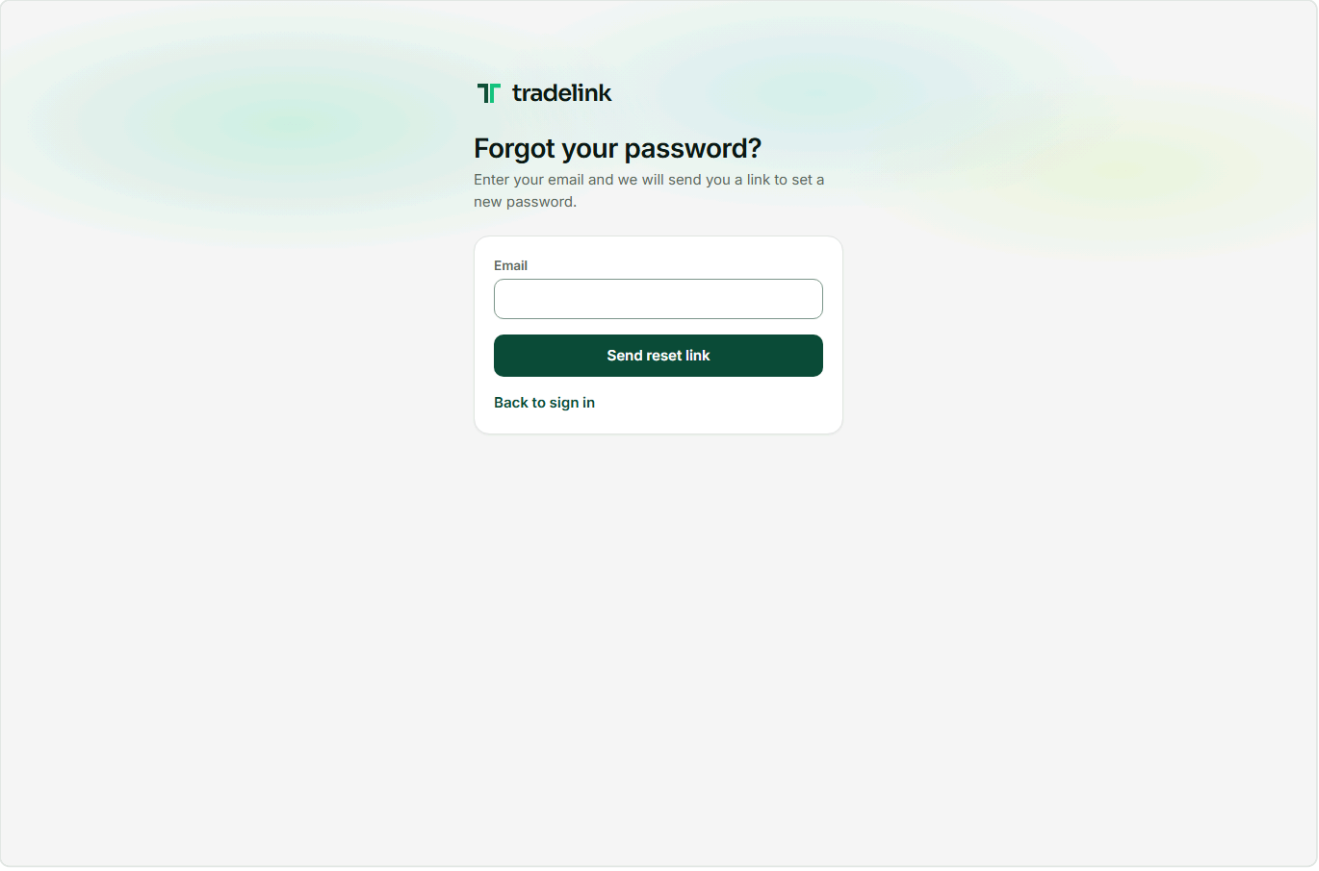


Figure 3. The forgot password page.

What happens next: you are signed in with your new password.

Common problems

- **The page always says the email was sent.** This is deliberate: Tradelink never reveals which email addresses have accounts. If nothing arrives, check your spam folder and the spelling of your address.
- **"The link has expired."** Links work for a limited time. Request a new one.

2.3 Create an account

What this is for: a new buyer or supplier business joining Tradelink.

Before you start: decide whether you are joining as a buyer or a supplier. You need your business name, your full name, a phone number and an email address.

Steps

1. On the sign-in page, under "New to Tradelink?", select **Create an account**.
2. Choose **buyer** or **supplier**.
3. Enter your business name, your full name, phone number and email address.
4. Choose a password and enter it again to confirm.
5. Submit the form.

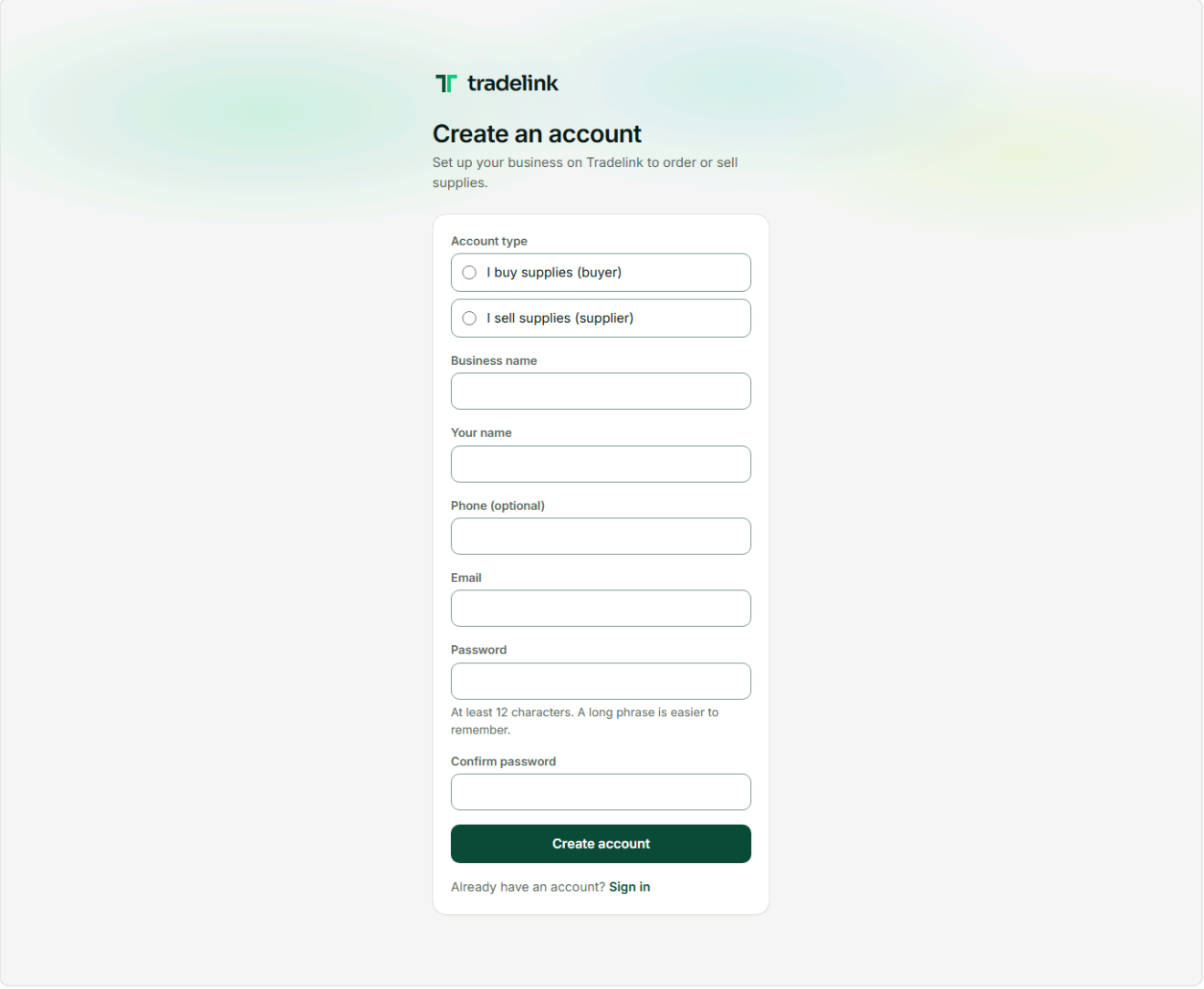


Figure 4. Creating an account.

What happens next

- Your business is set up straight away. A new buyer is connected to every active supplier, and a new supplier to every active buyer.
- The Tradelink team is told that a new account was created.
- If email confirmation is switched on, Tradelink asks you to confirm your email first.

Common problems

- **"That business name may already be in use."** Another business of the same kind already has that name. This includes a supplier that a buyer has already added to Tradelink (see 4.6). Contact the Tradelink team.

> **Not available yet:** joining through an invitation link. Supplier invitations are not sent by email, and an invited supplier cannot yet take over the record a buyer created for them.

2.4 Add Tradelink to your phone's home screen

What this is for: opening Tradelink from an icon, like an app.

Before you start: open Tradelink in your phone's browser and sign in.

Steps

1. Open the browser menu. In Chrome, this is the three dots; in Safari, it is the Share button.
2. Choose **Add to Home screen** or **Install app**. The wording depends on your browser.
3. Confirm.

What happens next: an icon named **Tradelink AI** appears on your home screen and opens the app full screen. Tradelink does not show its own install prompt; the option is always in your browser's menu.

Common problems

- **No install option.** Some browsers do not offer it. Use Tradelink in the browser instead; everything works the same.

2.5 Use light and dark mode

What this is for: choosing a light or dark screen.

Steps

1. Select the moon or sun button at the top right of any page to switch between light and dark.
2. Or open **Settings** from your account menu and go to **Appearance**. Choose **System** (follow your device), **Light** or **Dark**.

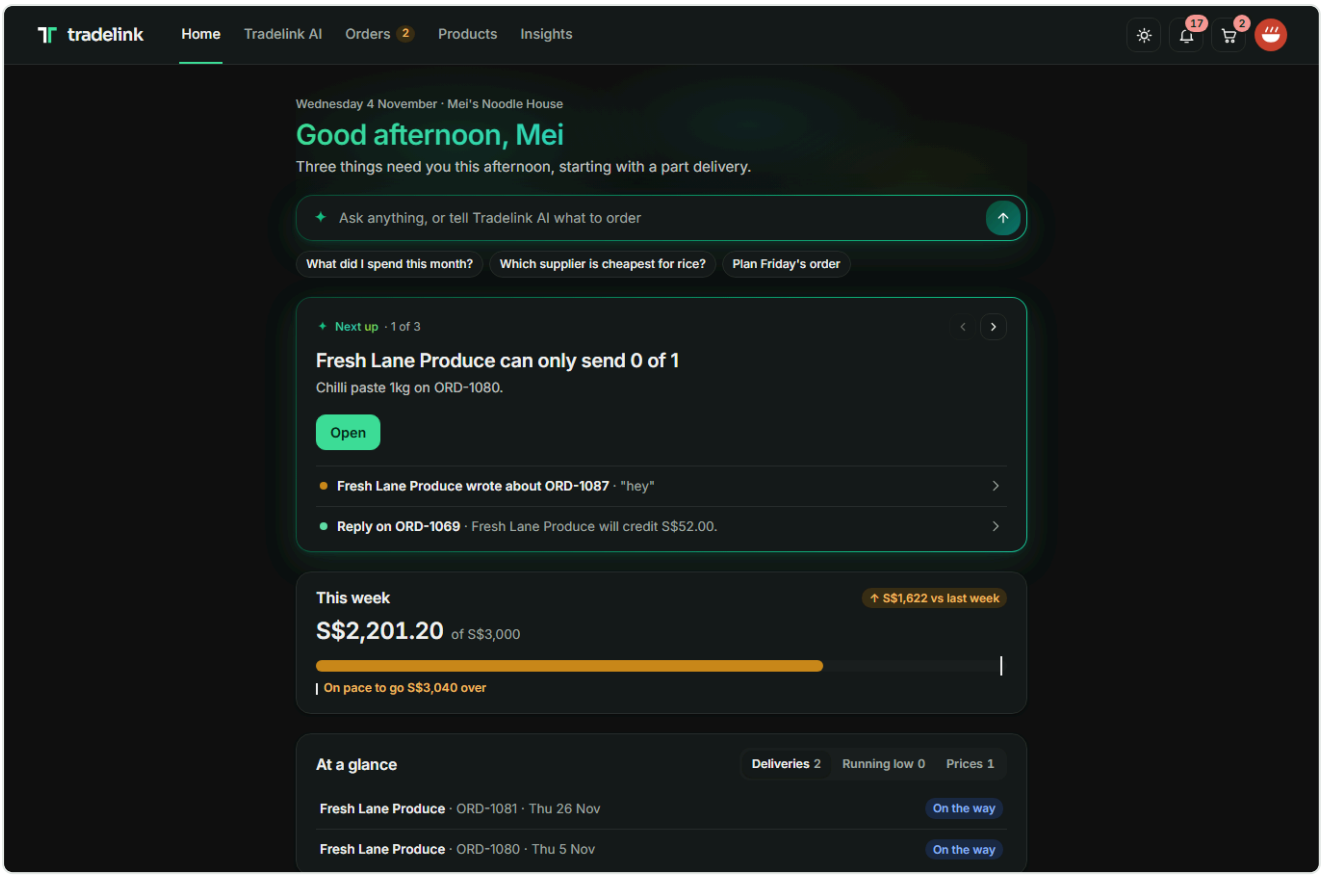


Figure 5. Buyer Home in dark mode.

What happens next: the change applies at once.

Common problems

- **My choice did not follow me to another device.** The setting is remembered on each browser separately. Set it once on each device.

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3. Understanding the app

3.1 The Home page

Every role starts on a Home page with the same pattern:

1. A greeting and a one-line summary of the day.
2. **Next up**: the most important thing to do now, shown large. Use the arrows, or tap a row underneath, to bring another item forward. "1 of 3" tells you how many there are.
3. Figures for the day or week.
4. **At a glance** tabs with short lists, such as deliveries or low stock.

3.2 Navigation on phone and laptop

	Laptop (760 pixels wide or more)	Phone
Main sections	Across the top bar	Tabs along the bottom of the screen
More sections	All visible in the top bar	Admins get a **More** tab for Users, Operators and Audit log
Alerts	Bell button at the top right	Bell button at the top right
Settings and Sign out	Account menu (your picture at the top right)	Account menu
Cart (buyers)	Cart button at the top right, showing the number of lines	Same

Role	Sections
Buyer	Home, Tradelink AI, Orders, Products, Insights
Supplier	Home, Tradelink AI, Orders, Inventory, Activity
Admin	Home, Attention, Orders, Suppliers, Users, Operators, Audit log

A small number next to a section shows how many things wait for you there, for example deliveries to check.

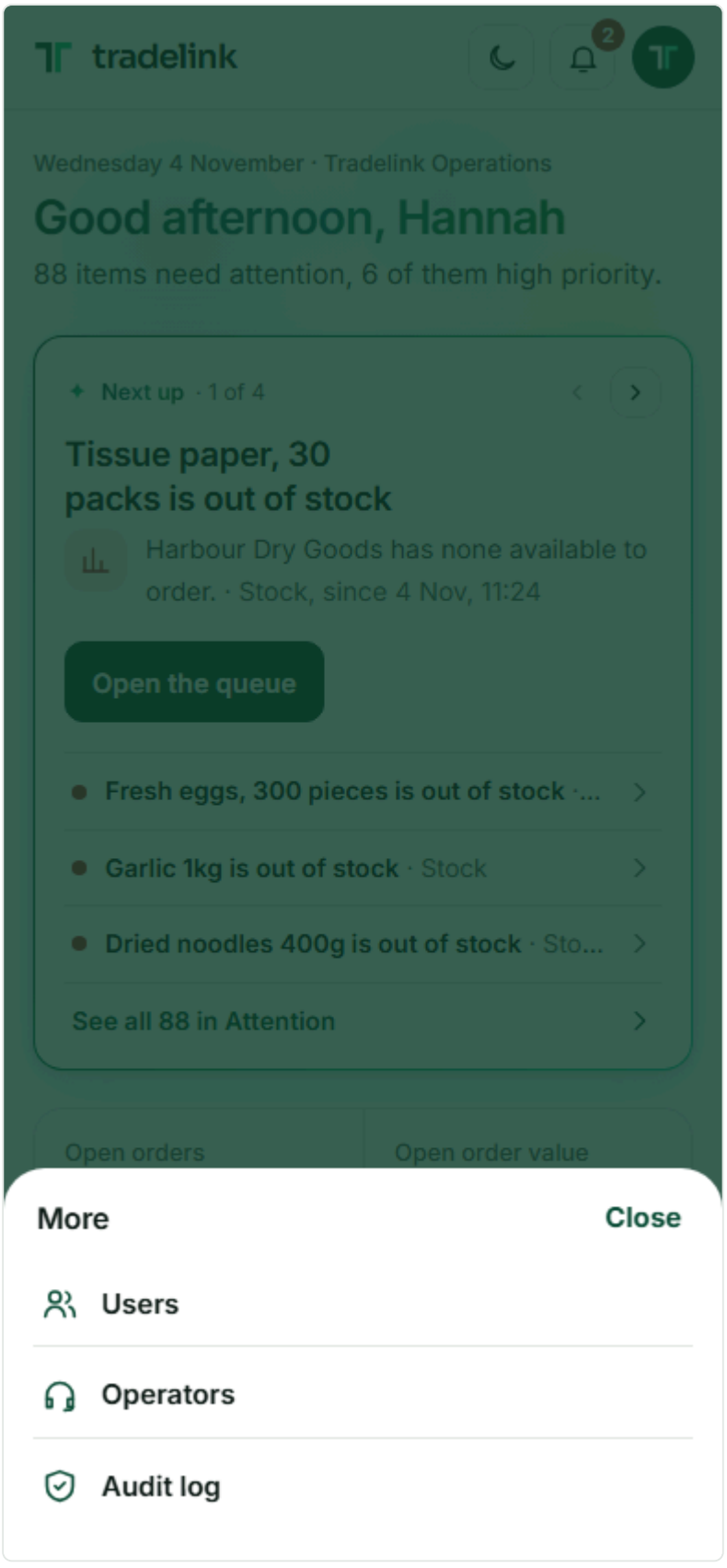


Figure 6. On a phone, extra admin sections open from More.

3.3 Status labels

Orders

Label	Meaning
Placed (Pending)	Sent to the supplier, waiting for them to accept
Accepted	The supplier will deliver on the confirmed date
Out for delivery	On its way
Delivered	The supplier has marked it delivered
Rejected	The supplier cannot take the order
Cancelled	The buyer cancelled it, or it was cancelled because the supplier was suspended
Below minimum	The order is under the supplier's minimum order value. It is still sent.

Checking a delivery (buyers)

Label	Meaning
Check delivery	Delivered but not yet checked by you
All here	You confirmed everything arrived
Problem reported	You reported something wrong

Second delivery (when a supplier sends part of an order later)

Label	Meaning
The rest comes *date*	Waiting for the second delivery
The rest is on the way	The second delivery is out
Delivered or Cancelled	The rest arrived, or will not come

Problems, as a buyer sees them

Label	Meaning
Waiting	The supplier has not answered yet
Confirm credit	The supplier promised a credit. Confirm once it reaches you.
Replacement promised	The supplier will replace the items on the next delivery
Supplier replied	For a late delivery: the supplier says it is on the way
Under review	The supplier disputed it, and the Tradelink team will decide
Credit received	You confirmed the credit arrived
Closed	Settled with no credit

3.4 Notifications

Tradelink tells you about changes inside the app: new orders, accepted orders, deliveries, problems, credits, messages and date changes.

1. Select the **bell** at the top right to open the alerts panel. Each alert has a button that takes you straight to the right place, such as **Reply**, **Answer** or **Confirm credit**.
2. For the full list, open the Alerts page. Buyers see the tabs **All**, **Needs action** and **Updates**. Select **Mark all as read** to clear the count.

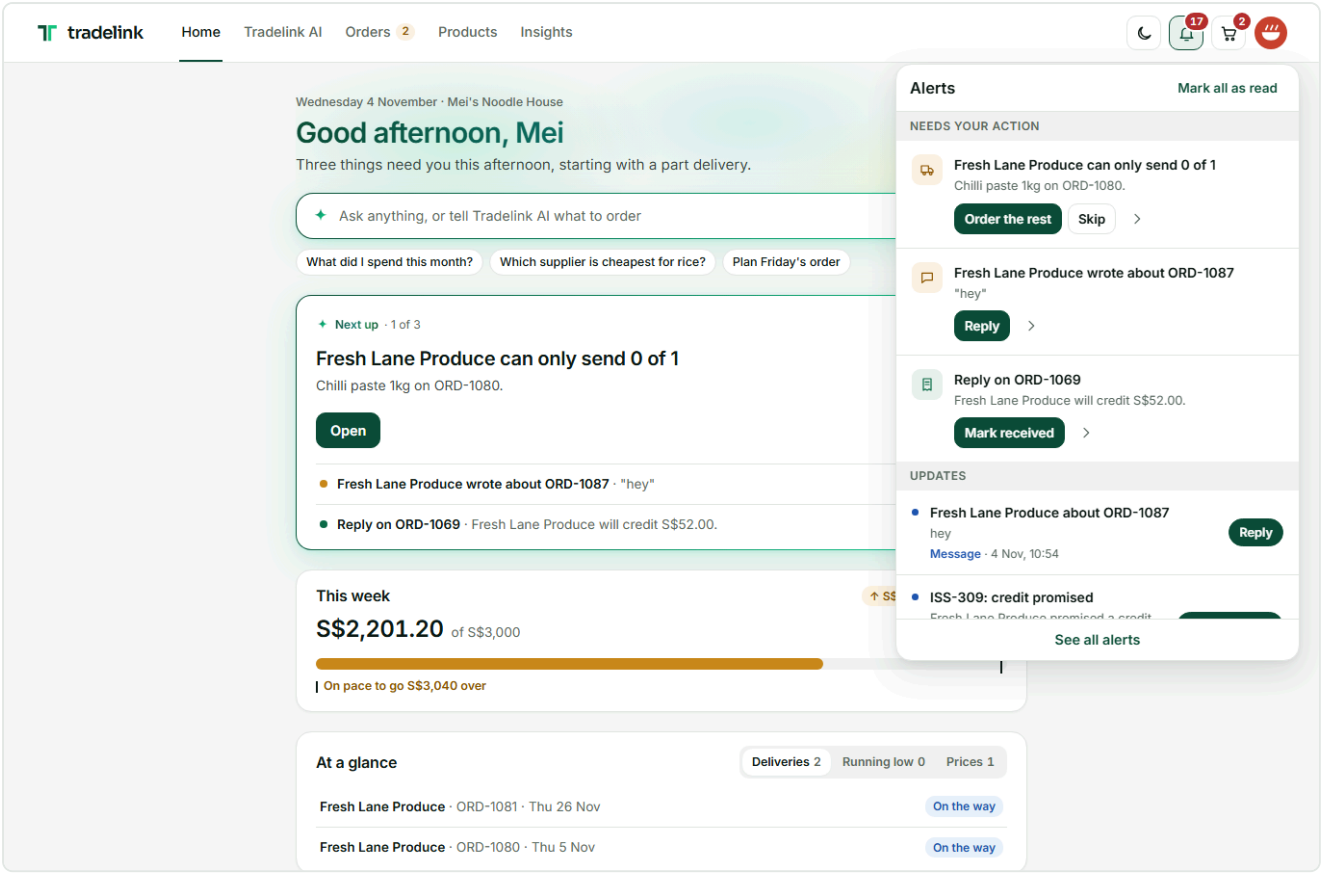


Figure 7. The alerts panel opens beside the page.

> **Not available yet:** email, text message and phone push notifications. All notifications are inside the app.

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4. Buyer guide

4.1 Understand Home

What this is for: seeing what needs you today at a glance.

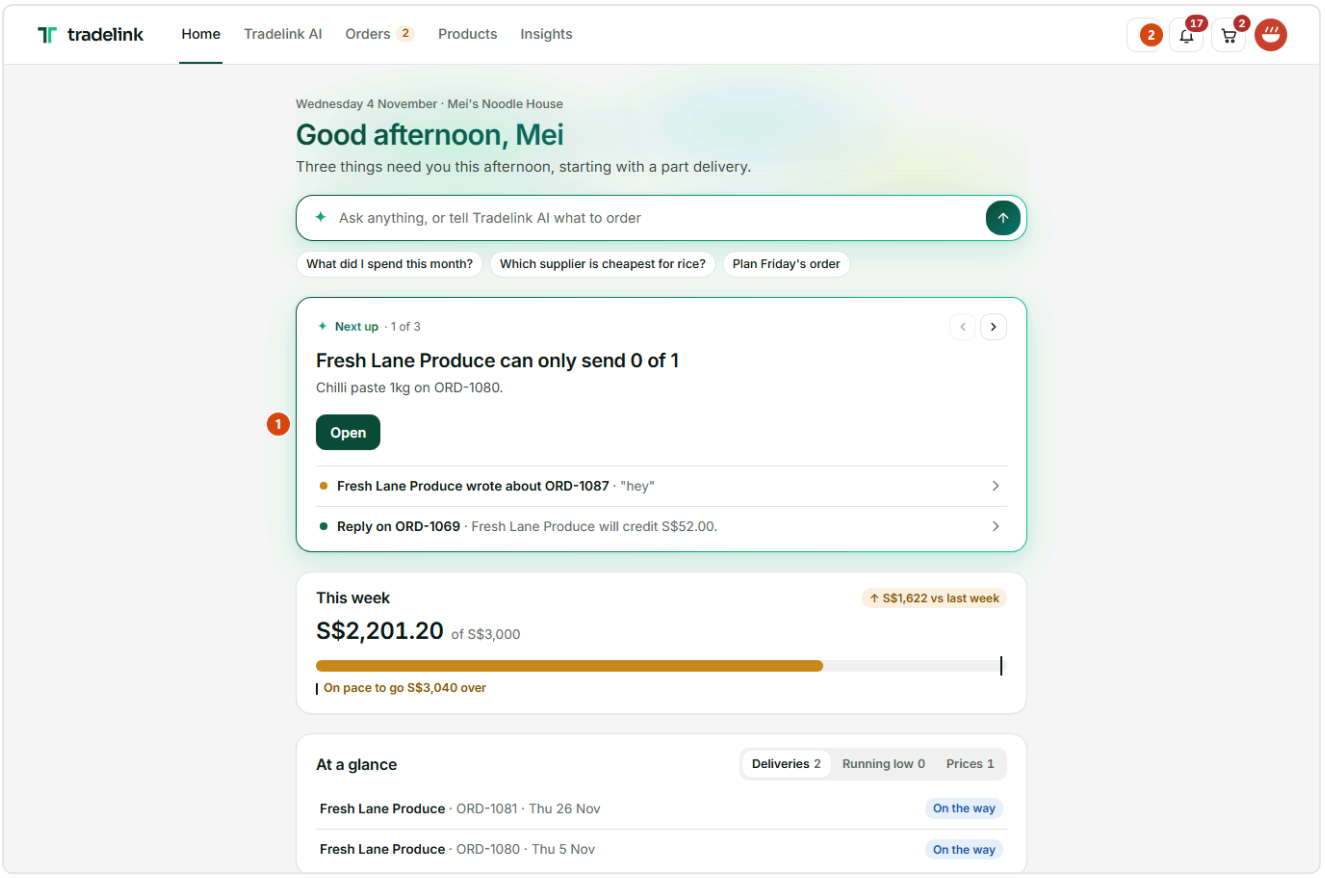


Figure 8. Buyer Home. (1) Next up shows the most important task. (2) The bell opens your alerts.

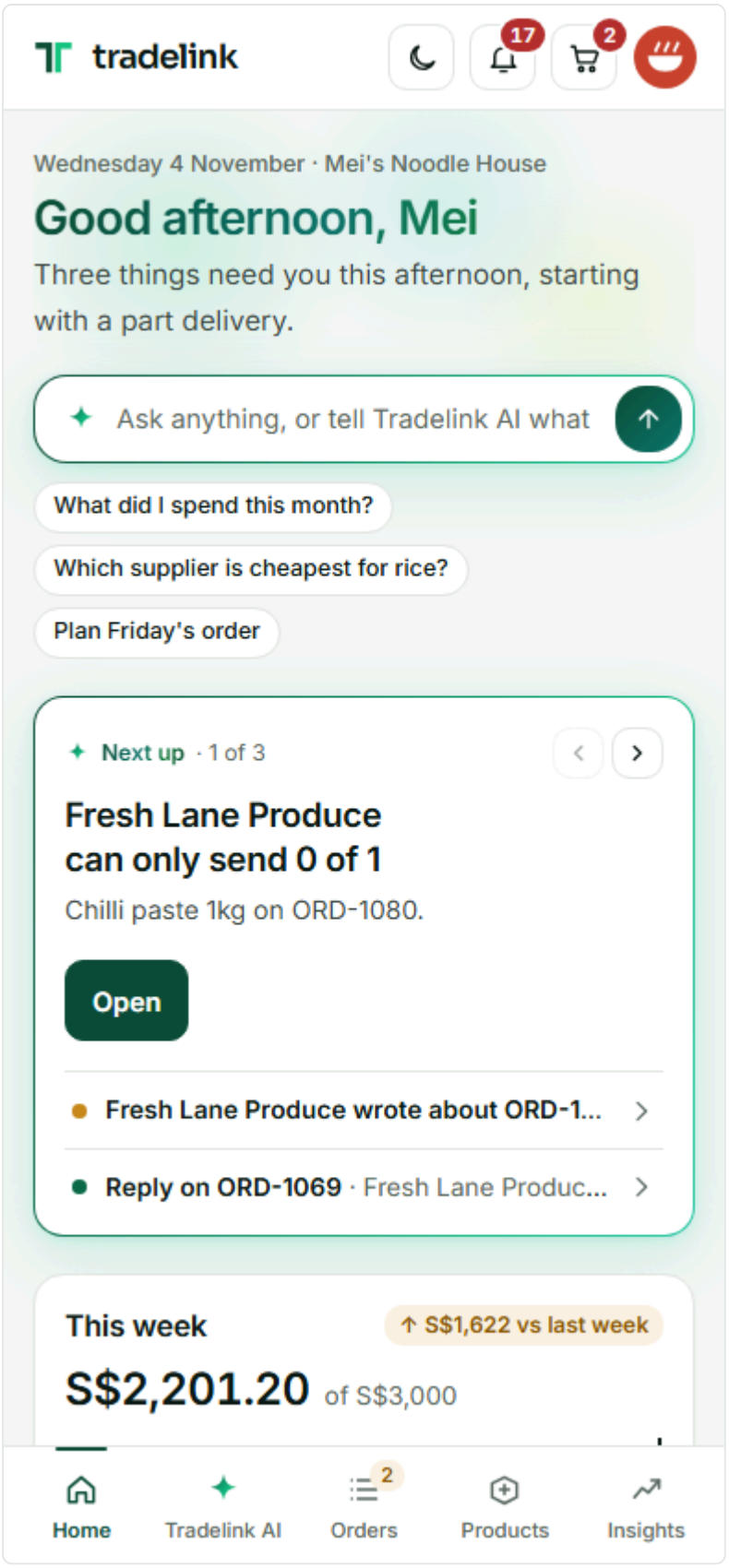


Figure 9. Buyer Home on a phone, with the bottom tabs.

Part of the page	What it shows
Ask bar	Type a question or an instruction for Tradelink AI. Suggestions under it are one-tap questions.

Part of the page	What it shows
Next up	Tasks such as **Place tomorrow's order**, a delivery to check, a credit to confirm or a message to answer.
This week	What you have spent this week against your weekly budget, and whether you are on pace to go over. Select it to open Insights.
At a glance	**Deliveries** on the way, items **Running low**, and recent **Prices** changes.

When nothing needs you, Home says: "Nothing needs you right now. Your usual items are covered and every delivery is checked."

4.2 Create an order with Tradelink AI

What this is for: ordering by typing what you need, the way you would text a supplier.

Before you start: you need suppliers with products on Tradelink.

Steps

1. Open **Tradelink AI**, or type in the ask bar on Home.
2. Type what you need, for example "Add 2 packets of dried noodles to my cart".
3. Read the reply. When Tradelink AI wants to change something, it shows a card marked **Needs your OK** listing exactly what will happen.
4. Select the card's button, for example **Add to cart**, to go ahead, or **Not now** to leave things as they are.

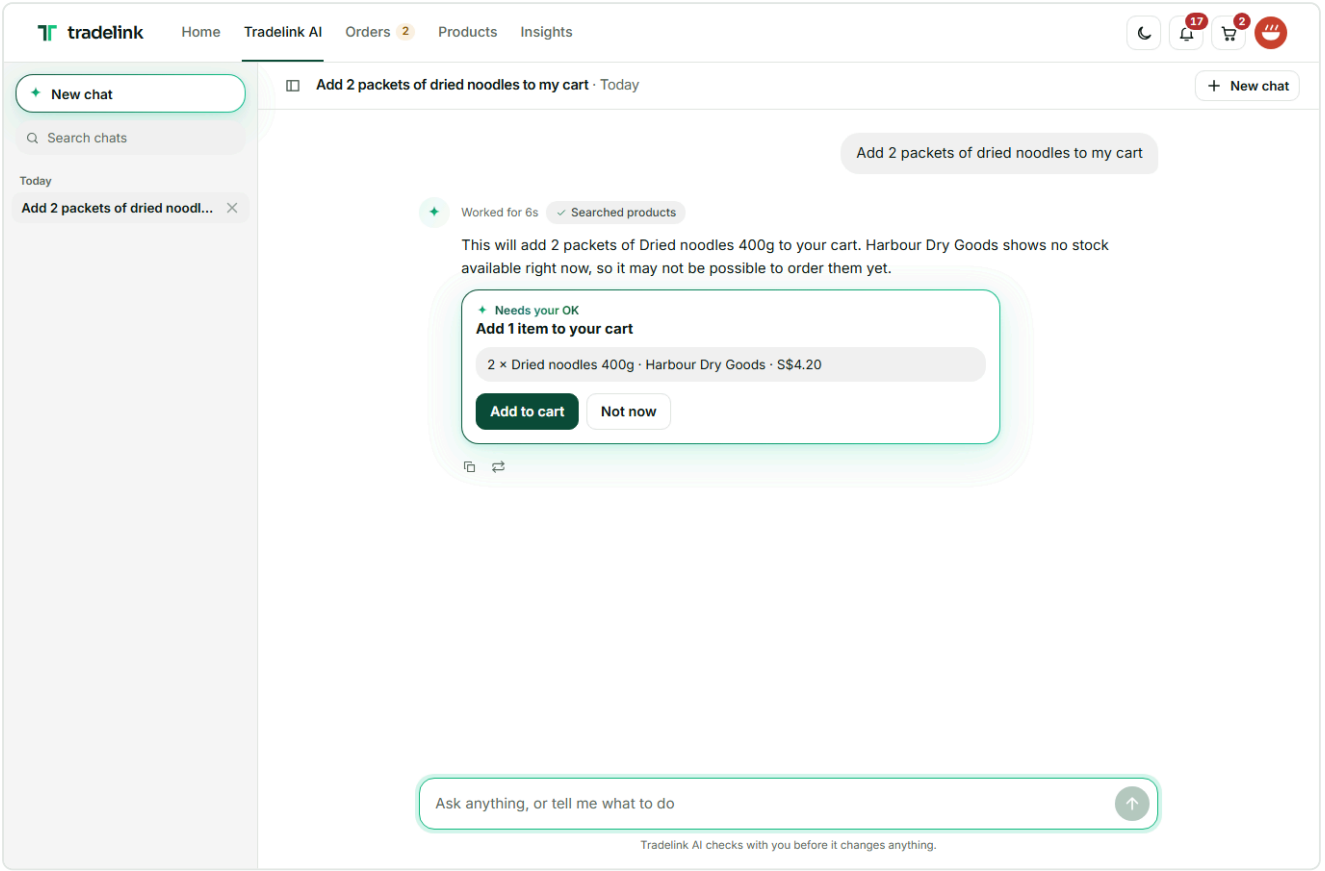


Figure 10. Tradelink AI shows what it will do and waits for your OK.

What happens next

- Items you confirm go into your cart, to review before you place the order (see 4.4).
- If you ask it to **order now**, the confirm card places that one order straight away and leaves your cart as it is.

Common problems

- **"Tradelink AI is not set up yet."** The assistant is not switched on for this installation. Use Products and the cart instead.
- **"Tradelink AI is not available right now."** Try again in a moment.
- **The reply mentions low or no stock.** You can still add the item, but the order may be short. Check the cart before placing.
- **You sent many messages quickly.** There is a limit of 60 messages an hour per person.

4.3 Order your usual items

What this is for: reordering what you buy regularly, without typing.

Before you start: set up your usual items in **Settings > Usual items**: how many you usually order, how many you have in the shop, and how many you use per day.

Steps

1. On Home, look for **Place tomorrow's order** in Next up. Tradelink suggests quantities from your usual items and how long your stock will last.
2. Choose one:
    - **Place orders** sends the orders straight away.
    - **Review in cart** puts the lines in your cart so you can change them first.
    - **Not today** hides the suggestion for today.
3. Or open the cart and select **Add my usual** to add all your usual items.

What happens next: placed orders go to each supplier. Lines in the cart wait for you to review them (see 4.4).

Common problems

- **No suggestion appears.** Your usual items are covered for now, or you have not set any up.

4.4 Review your cart and place the order

What this is for: checking every line before anything is sent to a supplier.

Before you start: add items from Products, Tradelink AI or **Add my usual**.

Steps

1. Select the **cart** button at the top right.

2. Check each supplier's lines. Use the minus and plus buttons to change quantities, swap a product, or remove a line.
3. Read the **Checked** line. It lists anything that blocks the order, such as more than the supplier has in stock.
4. Look at the warnings:
    - **Below minimum:** "Below *supplier*'s S$X minimum by S$Y". You can still place the order; the supplier sees the same warning.
    - **Budget:** how much of your weekly budget is left after this order.
5. Select **Place N orders · S$total**. You get one order for each supplier.

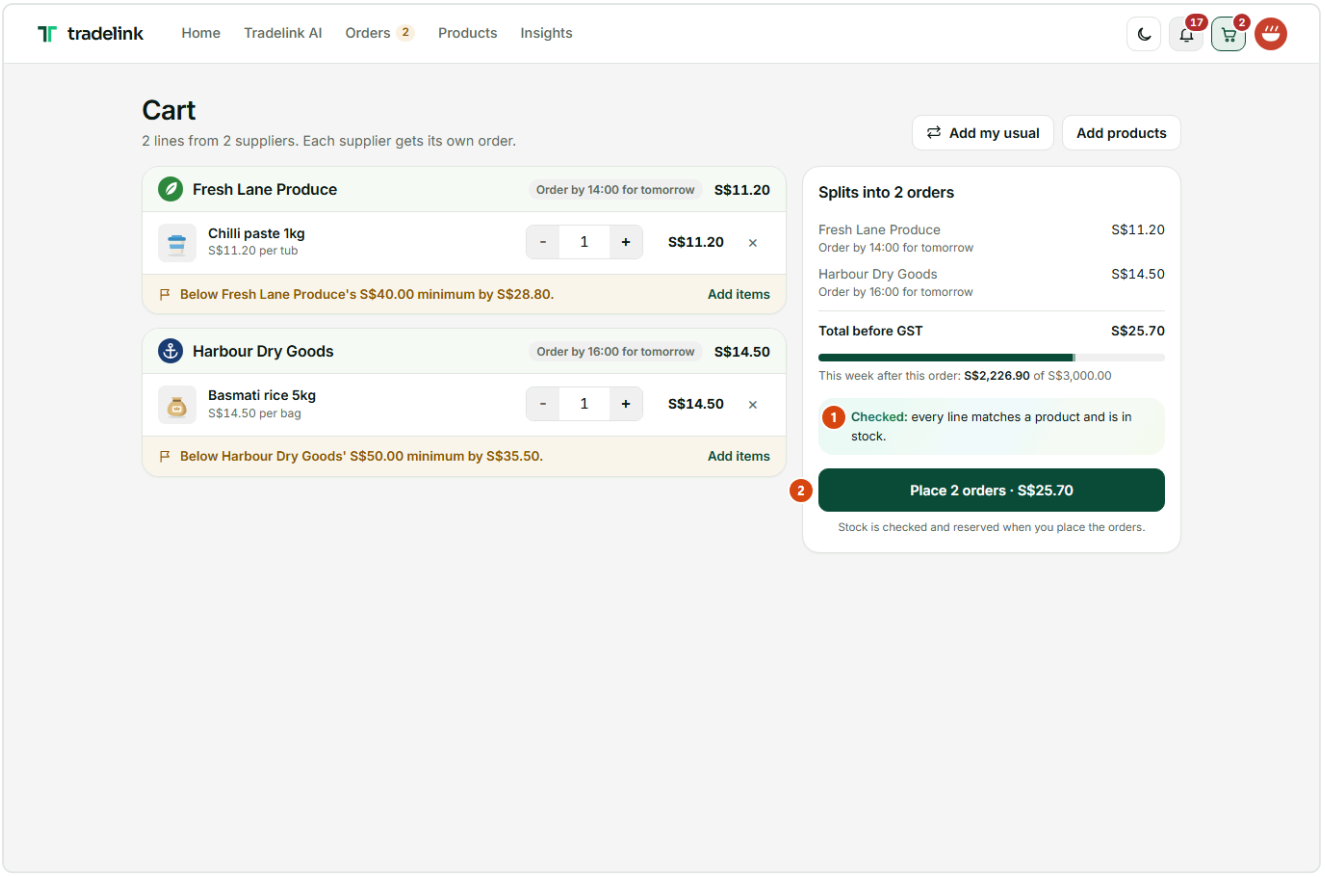


Figure 11. The cart. (1) The Checked line lists anything that must be fixed. (2) Place sends one order to each supplier.

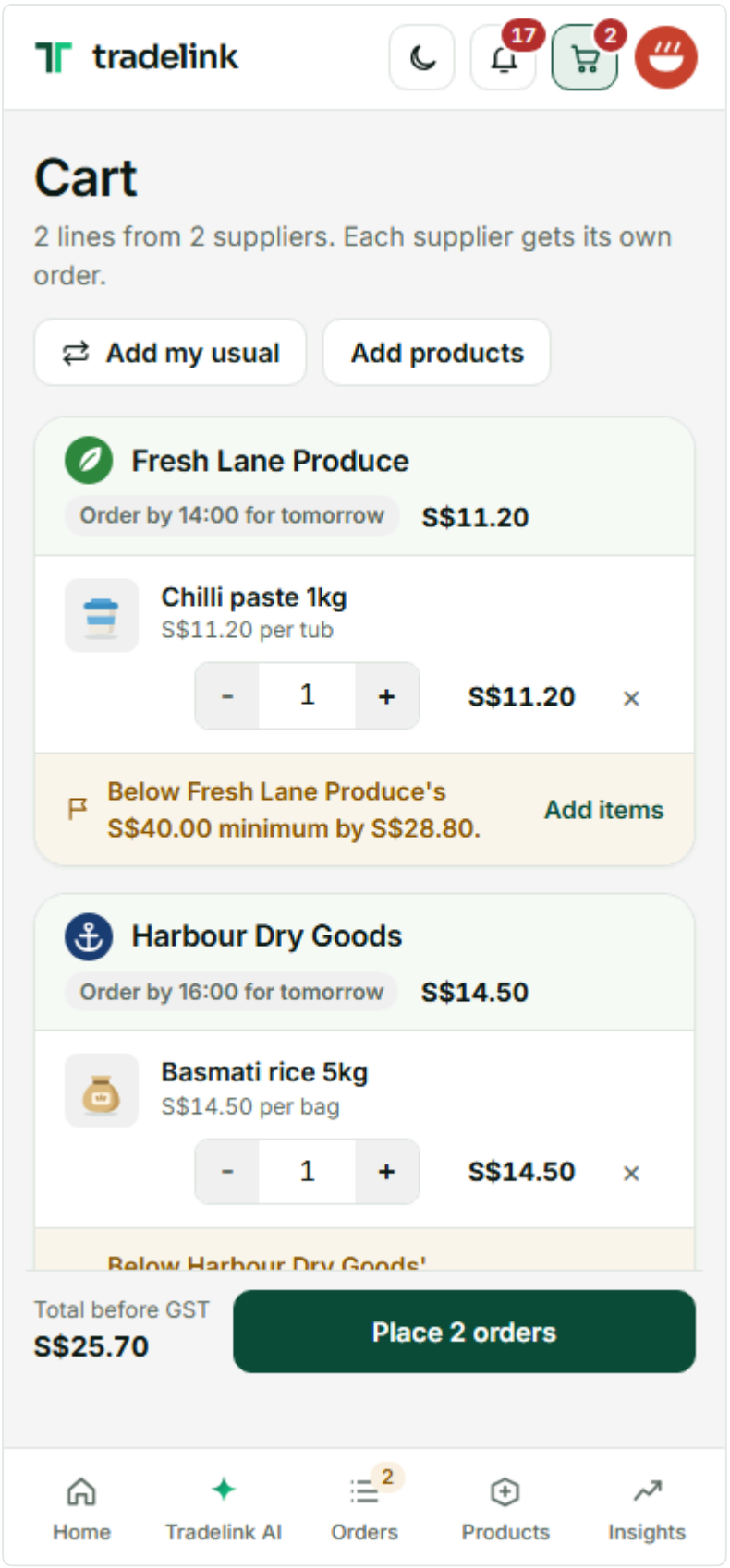


Figure 12. On a phone, the Place button stays at the bottom of the screen.

What happens next: "N orders placed and stock reserved." Stock is held for you the moment you place the order, so another buyer cannot take it. Each supplier gets a **New order** alert.

Common problems

- **Place is greyed out.** Fix the lines named in the Checked line first.
- **A line turns red after you select Place.** Another buyer took the last stock a moment earlier. Lower the quantity or remove the line.
- **"Waits for the supplier to accept your invitation."** The line is for a supplier that is not on Tradelink yet (see 4.6).

4.5 Add a product that is missing

What this is for: ordering something your supplier sells but that is not listed in Tradelink yet.

Steps

1. In the cart, select **Add to catalogue**. Or ask Tradelink AI, for example "add pandan leaves from Fresh Lane", and fill in the form card it shows.
2. Enter the **Product name**, how it is **Sold by**, the **Estimated price (S$)** and the **Supplier**.
3. Save.

What happens next: the product is added as **not confirmed**, and the supplier gets a **Product added** alert. The supplier confirms the real price and stock before the line can be filled.

Common problems

- **"This already exists. Choose it from the list."** The supplier already lists a product with that name. Search Products for it.

4.6 Add a supplier who is not on Tradelink

What this is for: recording a supplier you buy from who has not joined yet.

Steps

1. Open **Tradelink AI** and ask it to add the supplier, for example "add Ah Seng Trading as a supplier".
2. Fill in the form card: business name, contact person and phone.
3. Select the card's button to add the supplier.

What happens next

- The supplier is listed as **Invited** in Settings > Suppliers. You can add products for them.
- If they have not joined after 24 hours, the Tradelink team sees it in their attention queue.

> **Not available yet:** Tradelink does not send the supplier an invitation email or link. Contact the supplier yourself. An invited supplier cannot yet join and take over the record you created; the Tradelink team will help.

4.7 Track your orders

What this is for: following each order from placing to delivery.

Steps

1. Open **Orders**.
2. Use the filters: **All**, **Active**, **To check**, **Delivered**, **Problems**, **Cancelled and rejected**. You can also search by order number or supplier.
3. Select an order to open it.

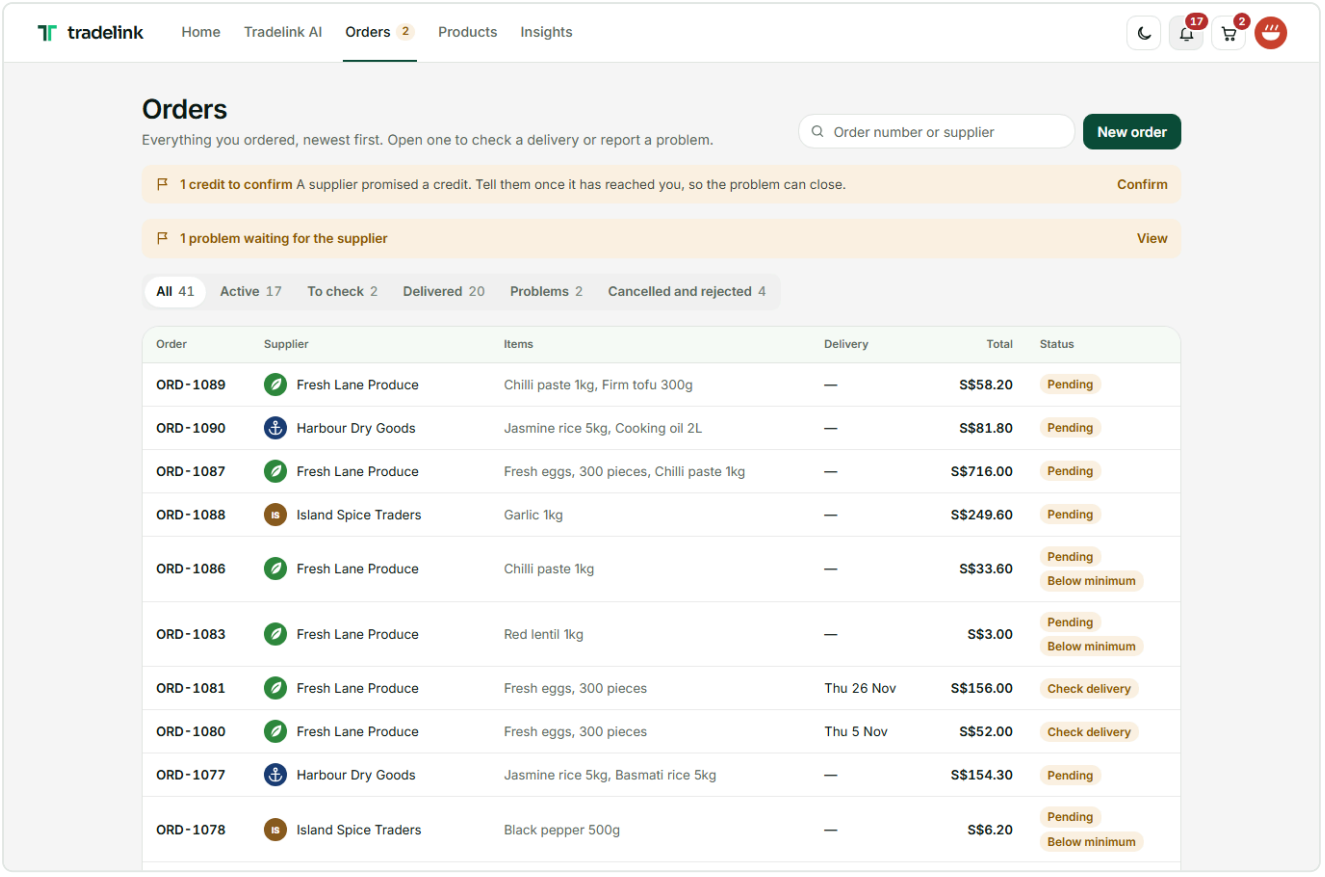


Figure 13. Orders on a laptop.

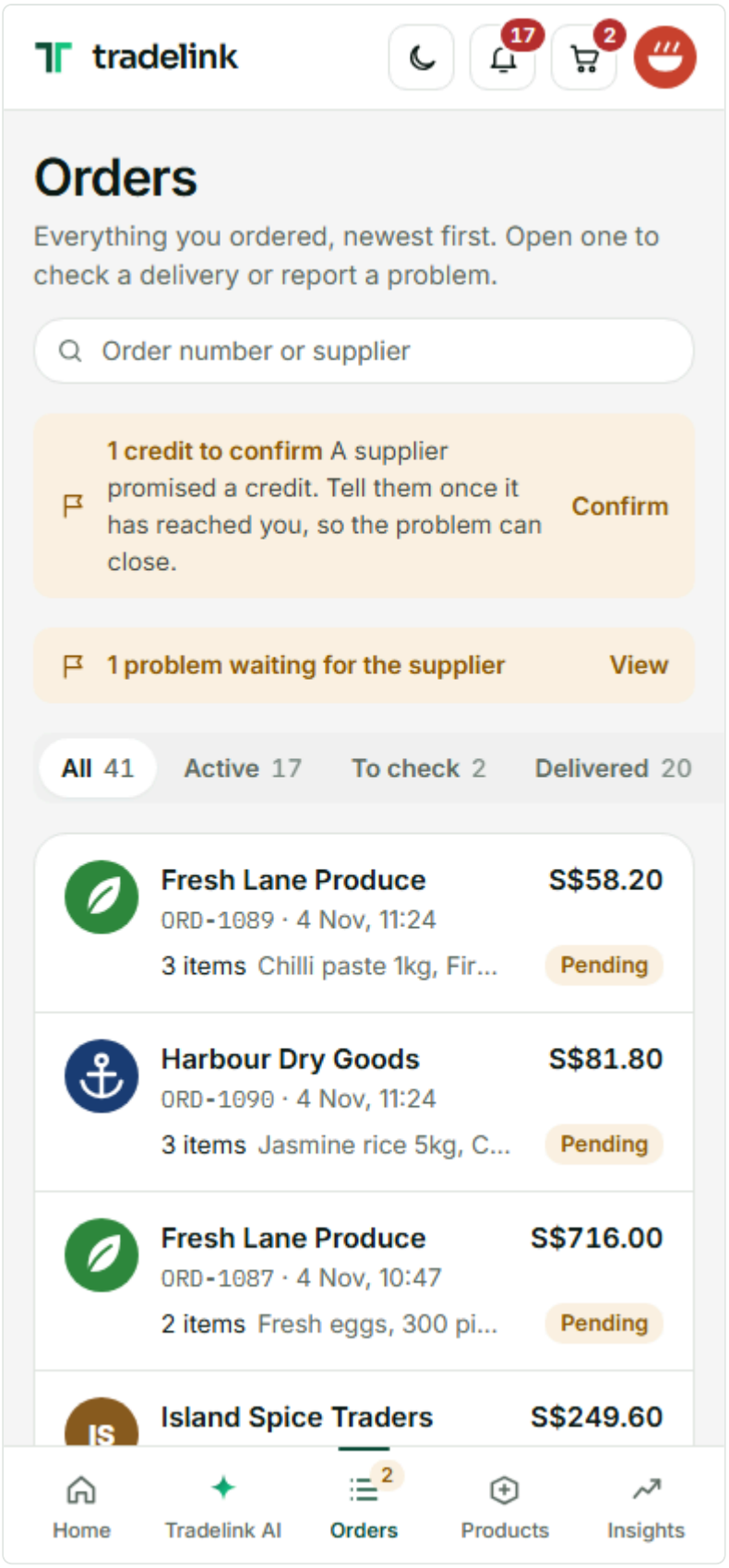


Figure 14. Orders on a phone.

On an order page you can see:

- the progress steps and the delivery date;
- the items and amounts;

- **"*Supplier* cannot send everything"** if the supplier accepted only part of the order;
- **"The rest comes *date*"** if the rest comes in a second delivery. Select **Cancel the rest** if you no longer want it;
- the **conversation**, with messages and date change requests.

Messages and date changes

- To message the supplier, type in **Messages with *supplier*** at the bottom of the order and select **Send message**. You can also ask Tradelink AI, for example "tell Harbour Dry Goods the back door is open"; it shows the message for your OK before sending.
- The **Tradelink AI** panel on the order page answers questions about that order, such as what to count first.
- To ask for a different delivery date, select **Change delivery date** in the messages section, choose which delivery and the **New date**, then select **Ask *supplier***. You can also ask Tradelink AI.
- When the supplier asks to move a date, the order and the alert show **Accept new date** and **Decline**.

Common problems

- **Cancel order is missing.** You can cancel only while the order is still waiting for the supplier to accept it.

4.8 Check a delivery

What this is for: confirming what arrived, so your stock counts stay right and problems are caught early.

Before you start: the order is **Out for delivery** or **Delivered**.

Steps

1. Open the order. Orders waiting for a check show **Check delivery**.
2. Choose one:
    - **All here**: everything arrived.
    - **Not here yet**: the delivery is late. This is only shown while the order is out for delivery.
    - **Report a problem**: something is short, damaged, wrong or expired (see 4.9).

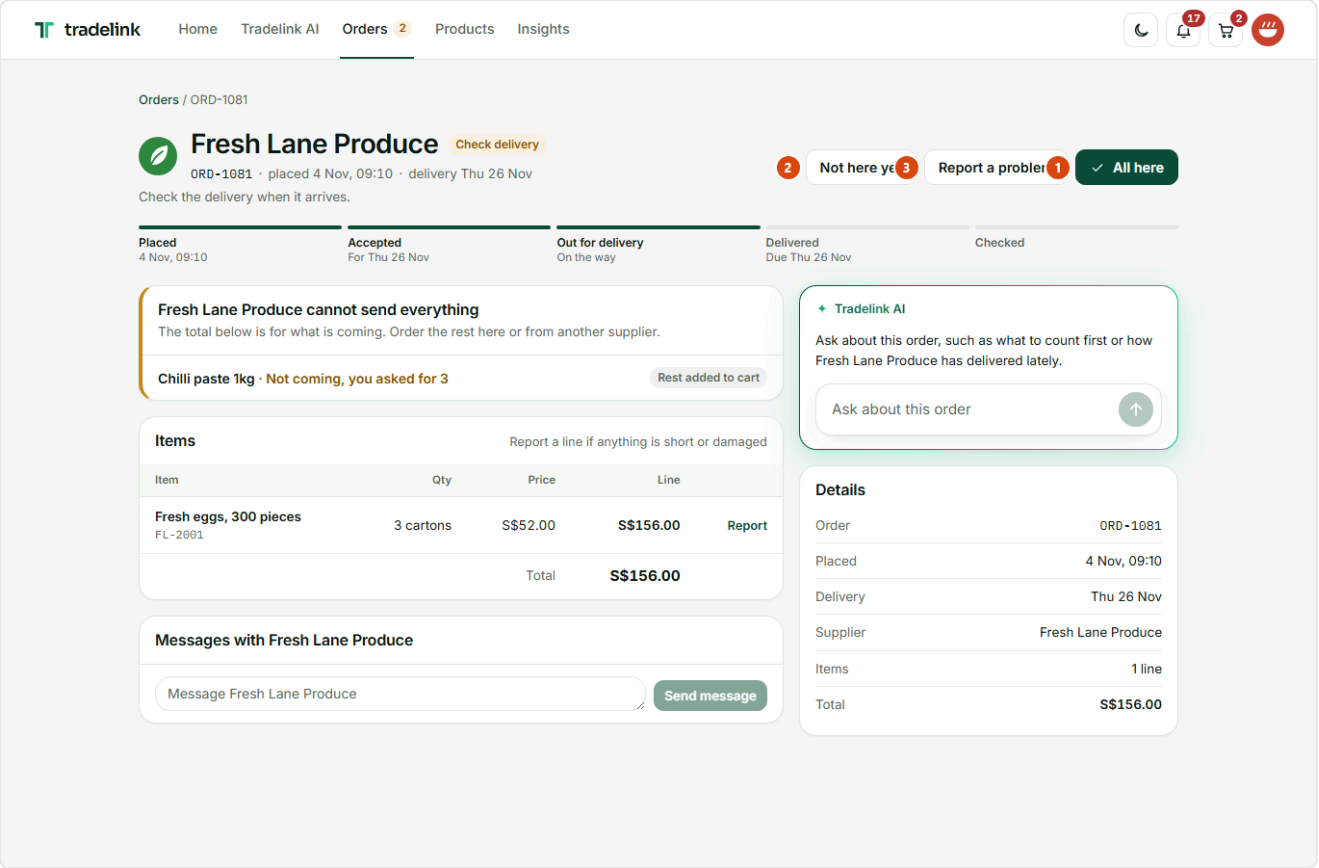


Figure 15. Checking a delivery. (1) All here. (2) Not here yet. (3) Report a problem.

What happens next

- **All here** marks the order checked and adds the items to your in-shop counts.
- **Not here yet** asks the supplier for an update.
- If the order was still out for delivery, either choice also marks it delivered.

Common problems

- **"You have already reported this order as late."** Wait for the supplier's answer.

4.9 Report a problem

What this is for: telling the supplier that part of a delivery was short, damaged, the wrong item, or expired.

Steps

1. Open the order and select **Report a problem**.
2. Choose the product, the kind of problem and the quantity affected.
3. Add a short note if it helps (up to 500 characters).
4. Send the report.

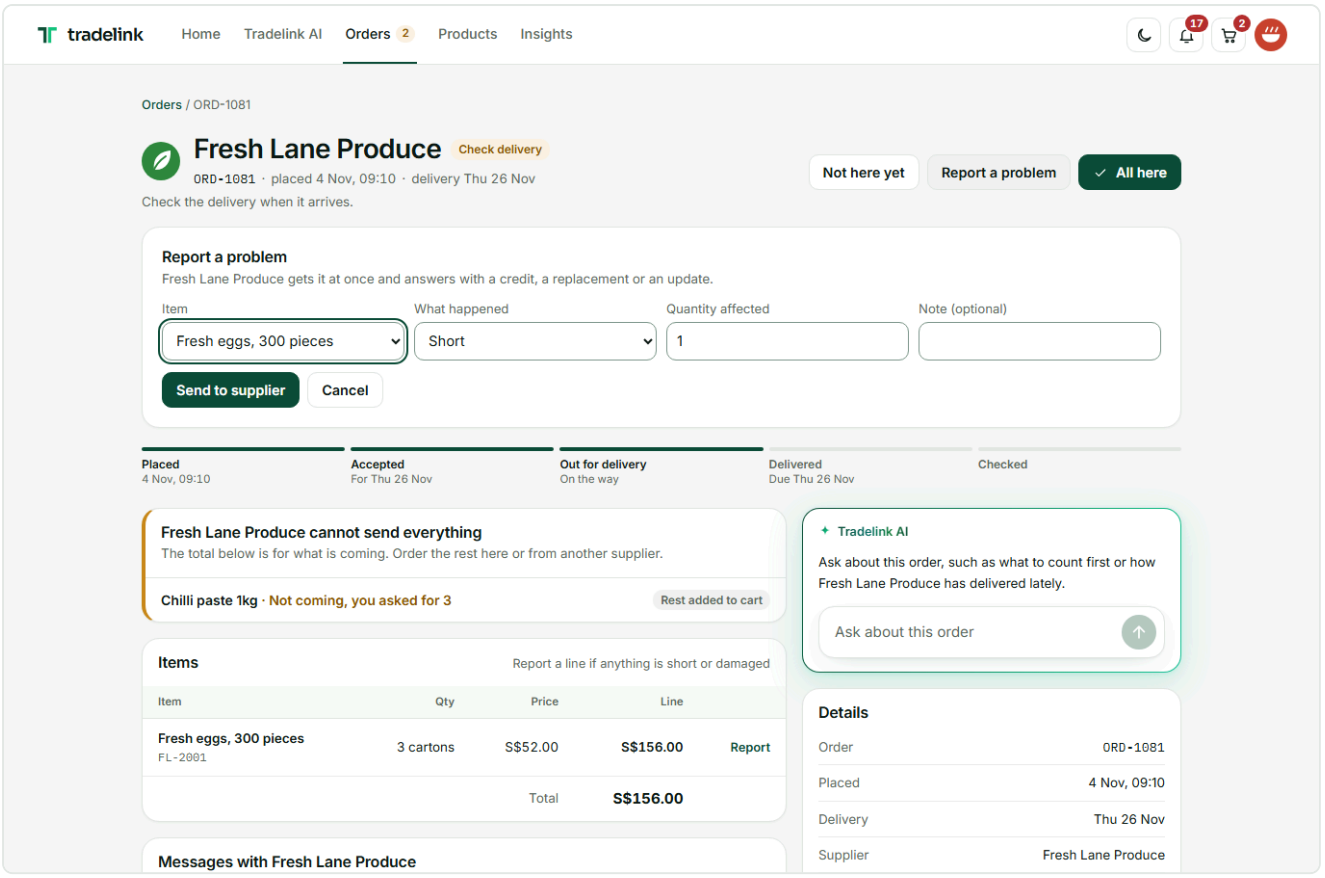


Figure 16. Reporting a problem on a delivery.

What happens next: the supplier gets a **Problem reported** alert. The amount is worked out as quantity × unit price. The problem shows as **Waiting** until the supplier answers with a credit, a replacement or a dispute. Problems unanswered for more than 4 hours, and disputes, go to the Tradelink team.

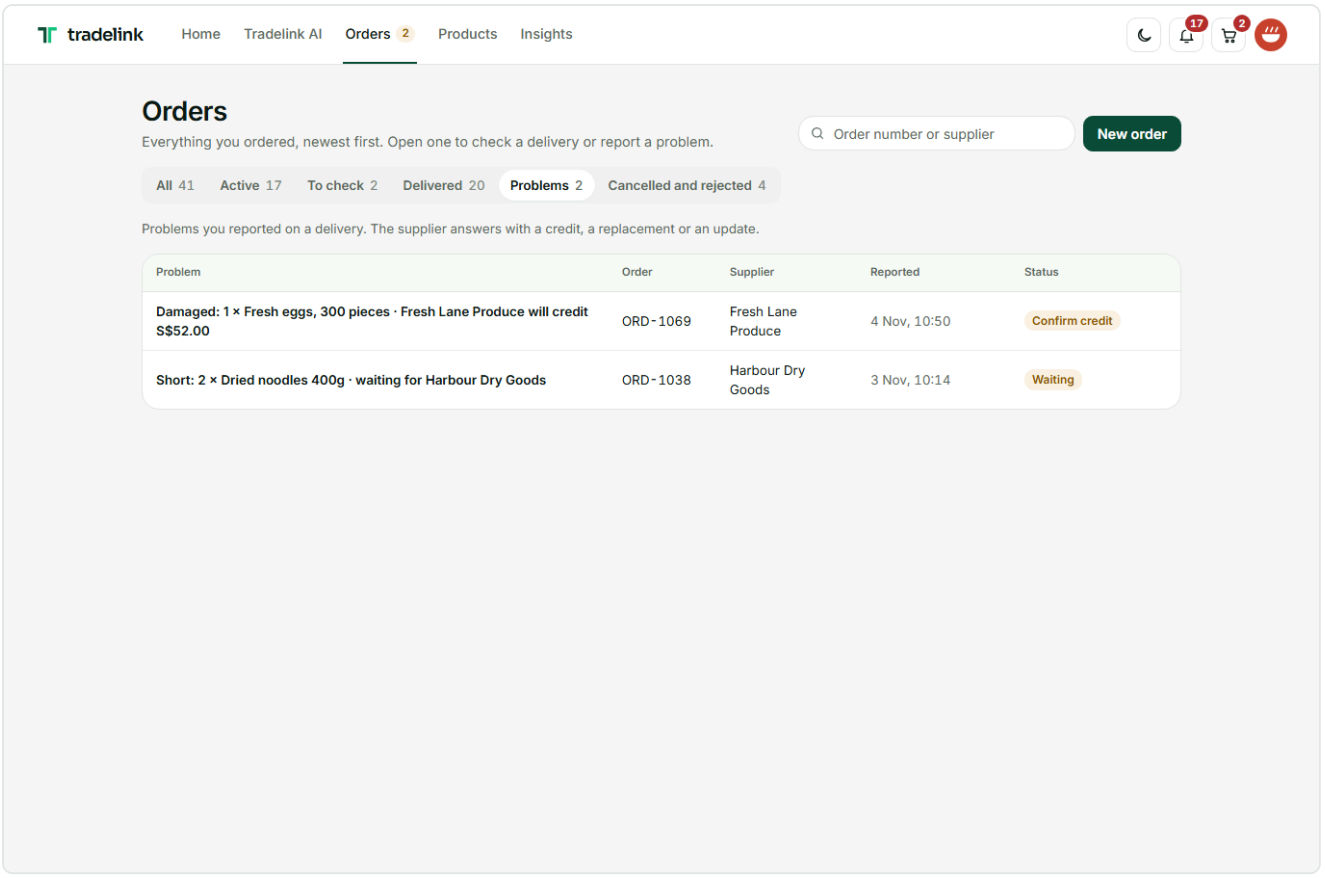


Figure 17. Orders > Problems lists every problem you reported.

4.10 Check credits

What this is for: making sure a credit the supplier promised really reached you.

Steps

1. When a supplier promises a credit, the problem shows **Confirm credit**, and Orders shows a "credit to confirm" banner.
2. Once the credit has reached you, open the order's problems and select **Mark credit received**.

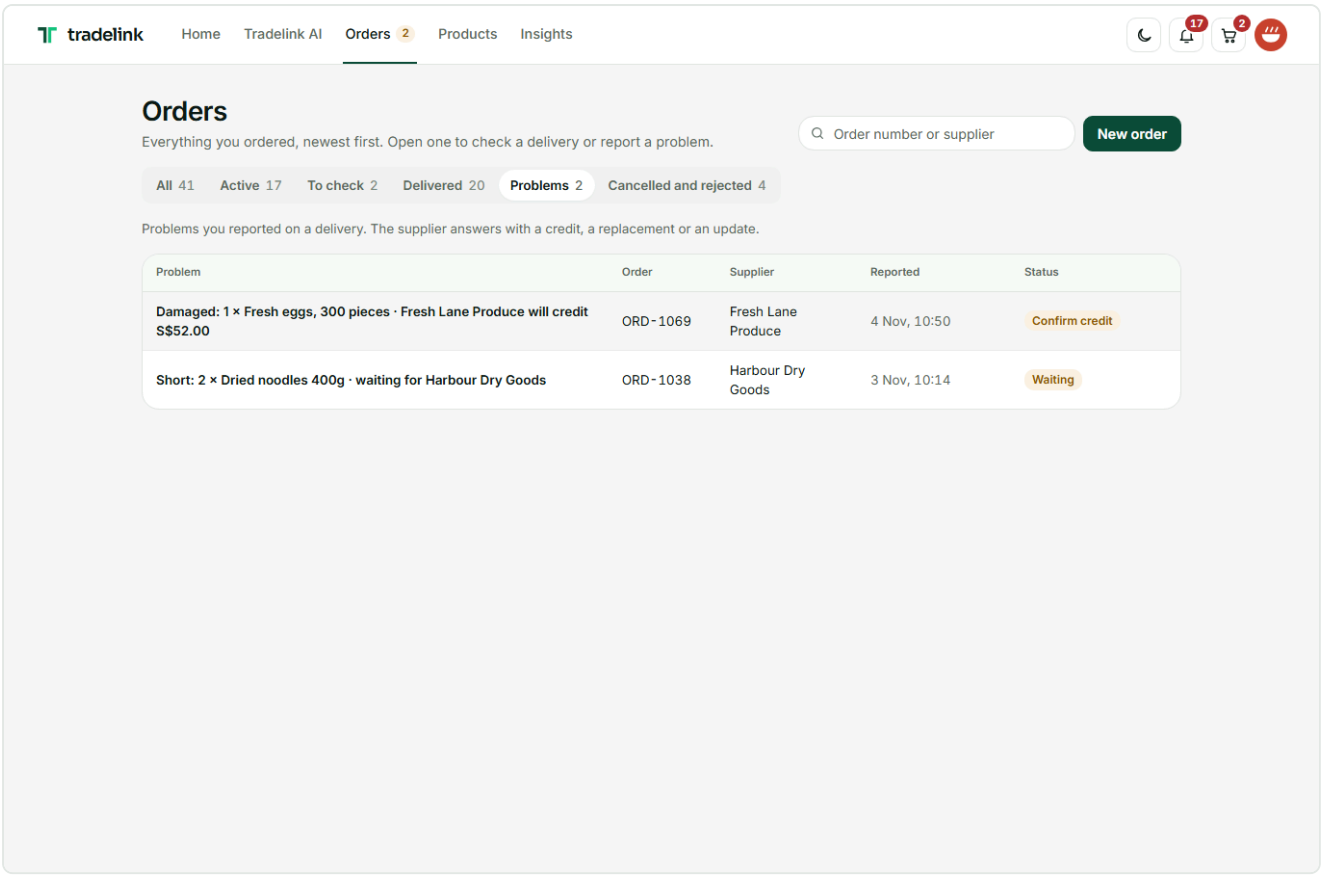


Figure 18. A problem on an order.

What happens next: the problem closes as **Credit received**, and the supplier is told.

> **Not available yet:** invoices. Tradelink does not hold, check or pay invoices, and an invoice query cannot be raised. Credits are tracked as described above.

4.11 Products, Insights and Settings

Products: search the catalogue of your connected suppliers. Filter by category or supplier, and add items to your cart. Product availability is part of this page.

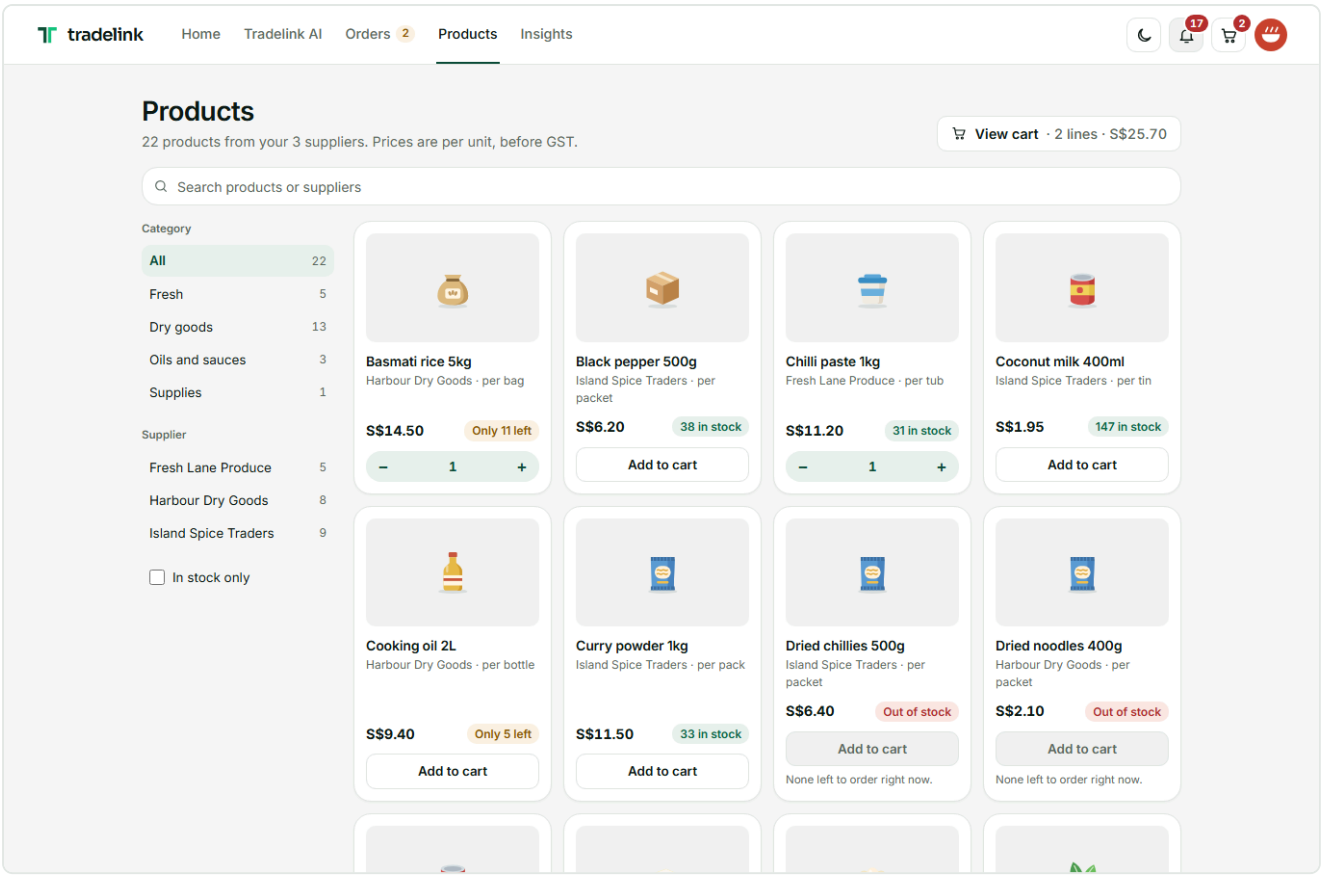


Figure 19. Products, with search and filters.

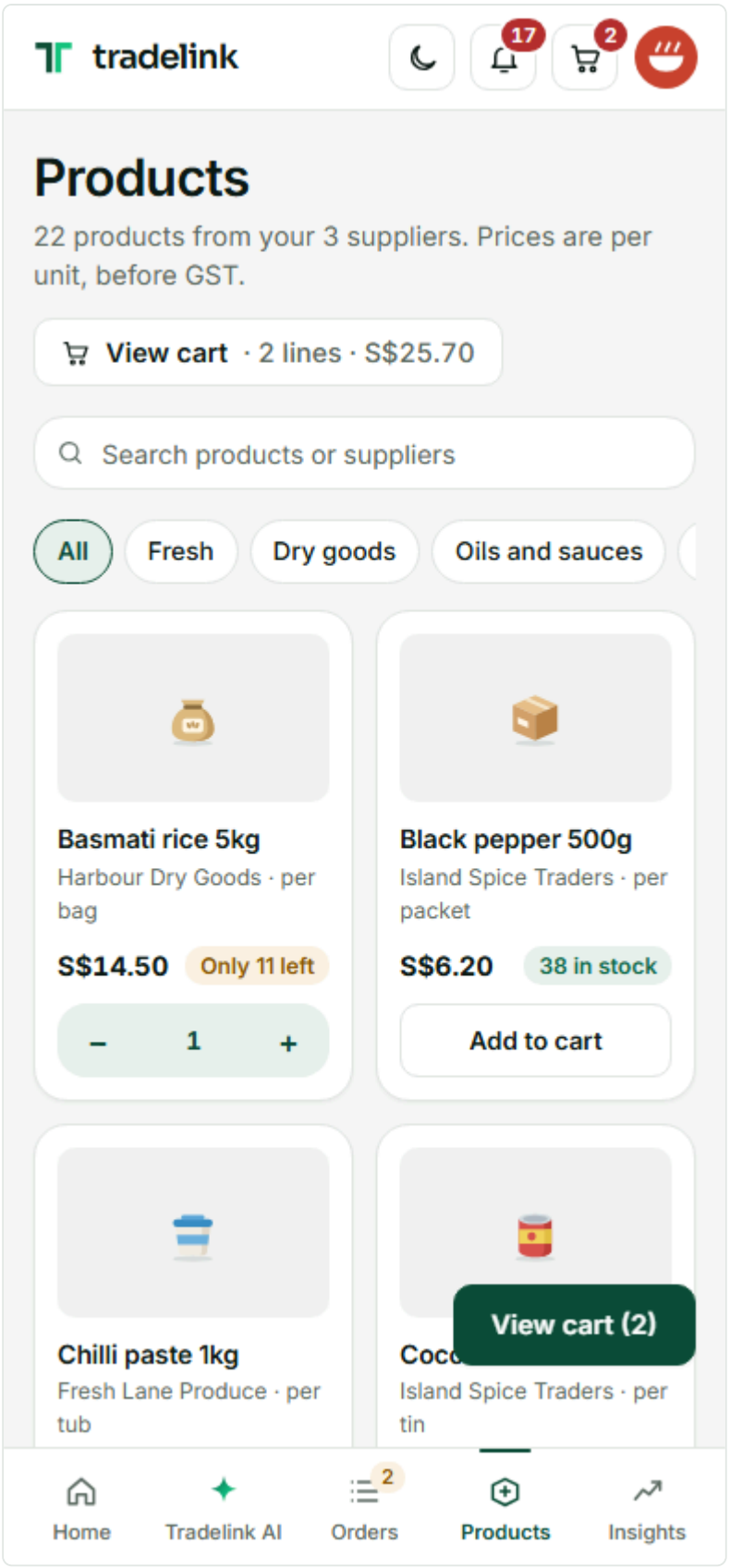


Figure 20. Products on a phone, with filter chips.

Insights: a read-only summary of your buying:

- an "In short" summary;
- spent this week and last week, your budget, and what is left;

- a weekly spend chart and spend by supplier;
- each supplier's on-time record;
- price changes.

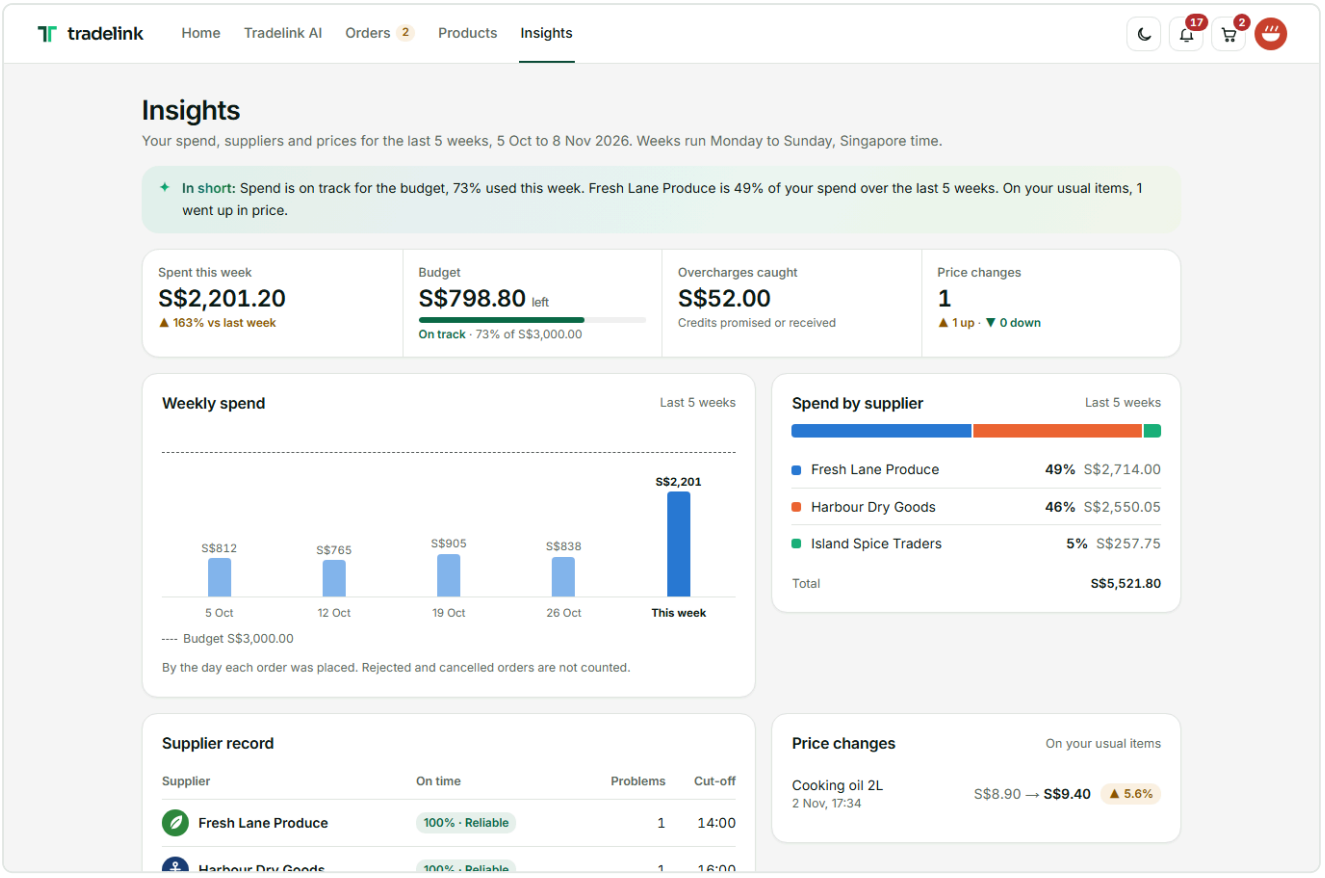


Figure 21. Insights.

Settings

Section	What you can change
Budget and alerts	Weekly budget, and switches for **Suggest what to reorder**, **Tell me about price changes** and **Warn me before I go over budget**
Usual items	Usual order quantity, how many are in your shop, and use per day
Suppliers	View only: each supplier shows **Connected** or **Invited**
Account and Appearance	Your account details, and light or dark mode

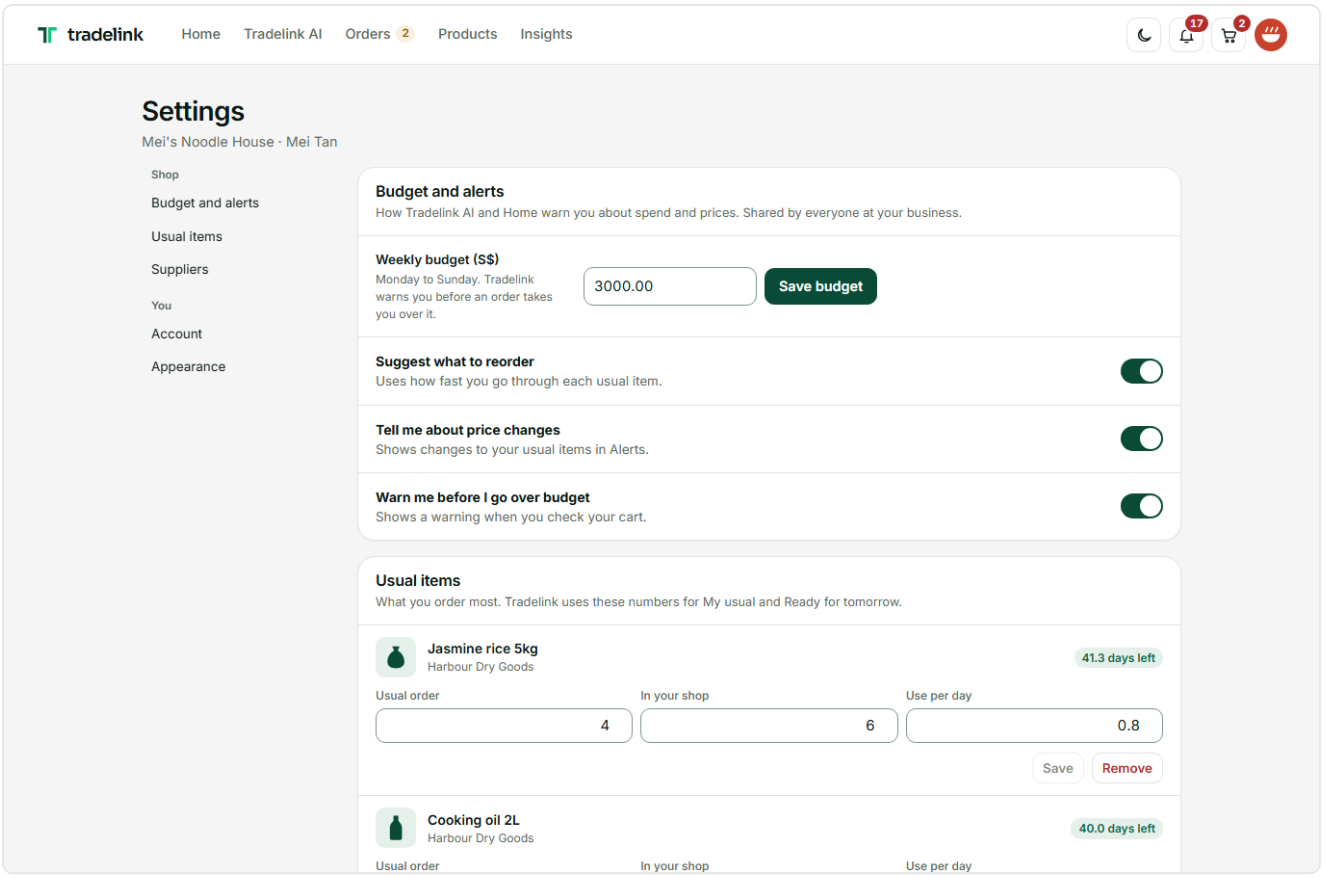


Figure 22. Buyer Settings.

> **Ask and Availability:** older links to Ask open Tradelink AI, and older links to Availability open Products.

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5. Supplier guide

5.1 Understand Home

What this is for: seeing the jobs waiting for you.

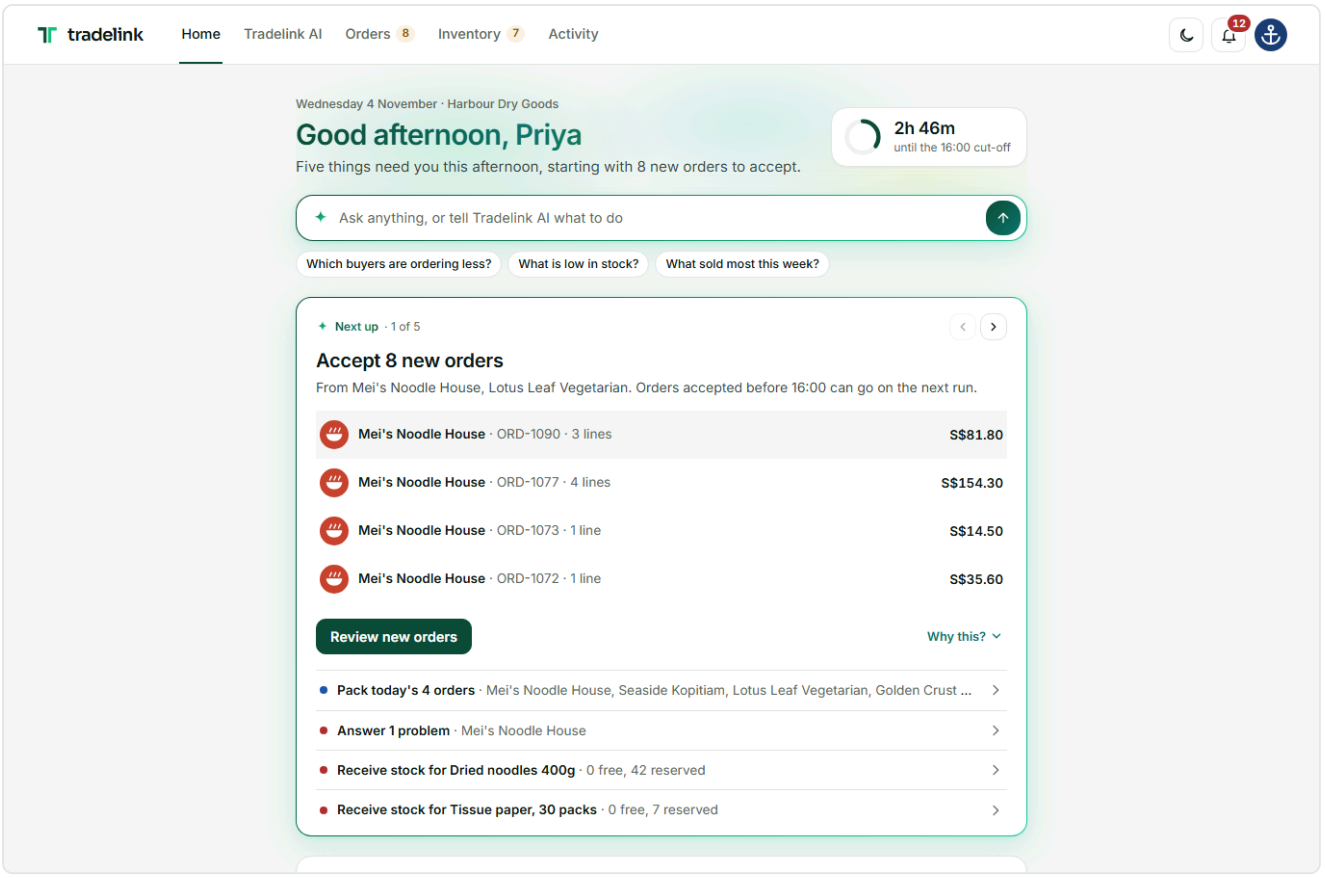


Figure 23. Supplier Home.

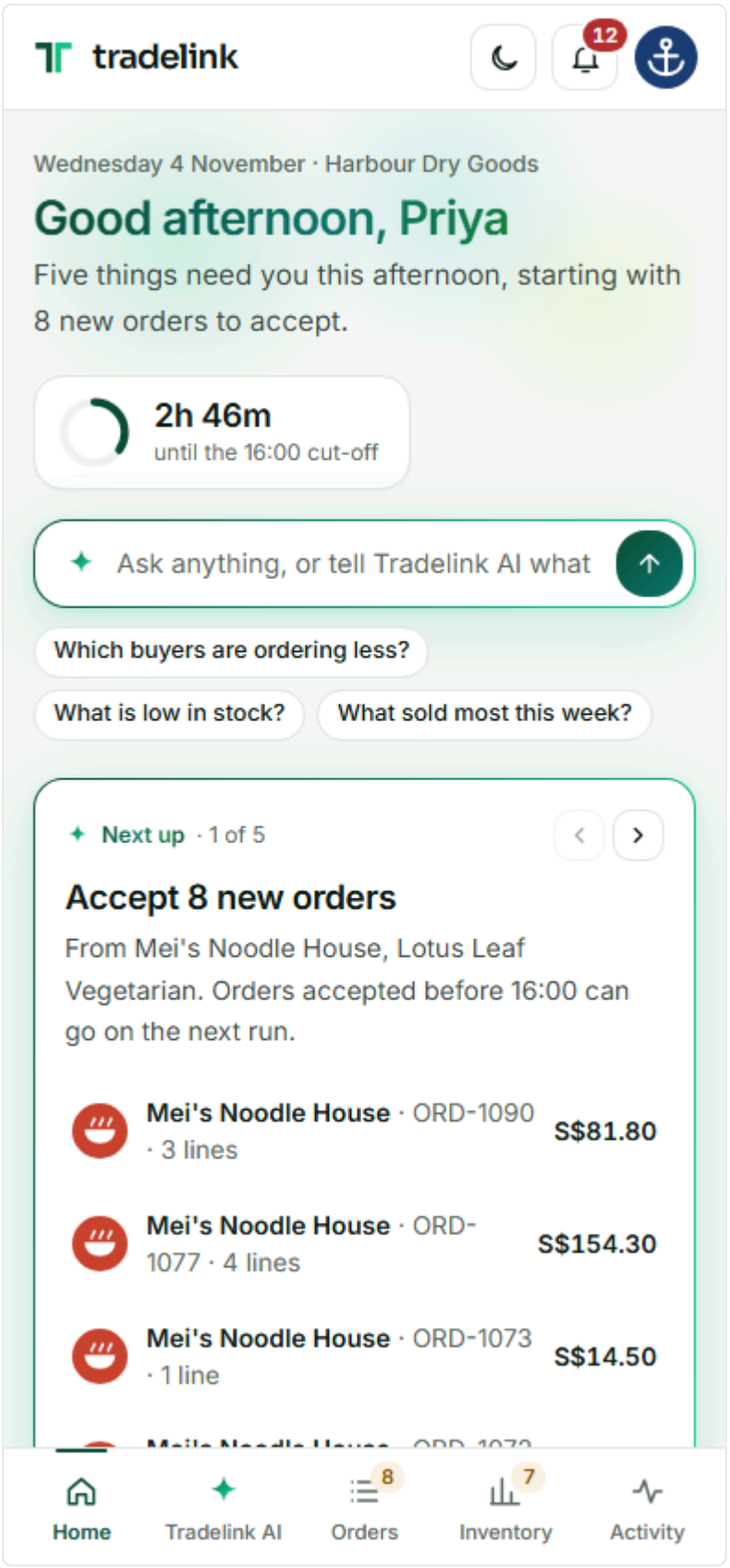


Figure 24. Supplier Home on a phone.

Part of the page	What it shows
Next up	The oldest job first: • Accept new orders. • Pack today's orders, as one pick list added up across orders, with **Mark all out for delivery**. • Answer problems. • Receive stock for an item that is running out. • A customer who has gone quiet.
Today	Order value and new orders so far, against a usual day of the same weekday
At a glance	**Customers**, **Running low** and **Coming up**

5.2 Accept, part accept or reject an order

What this is for: answering a new order.

Before you start: open **Orders > New**, then the order.

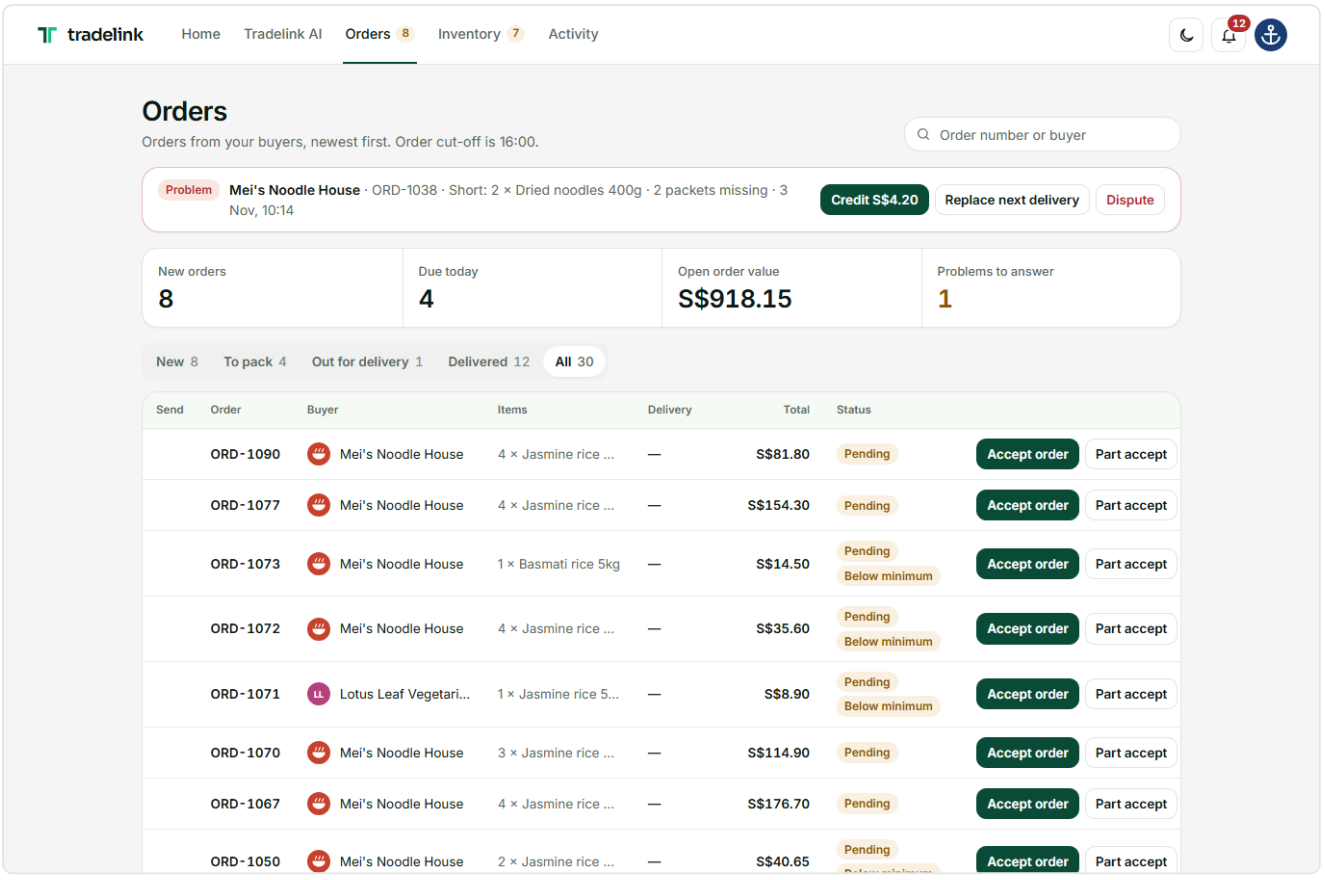


Figure 25. Orders, with the New, To pack, Out for delivery, Delivered and All tabs.

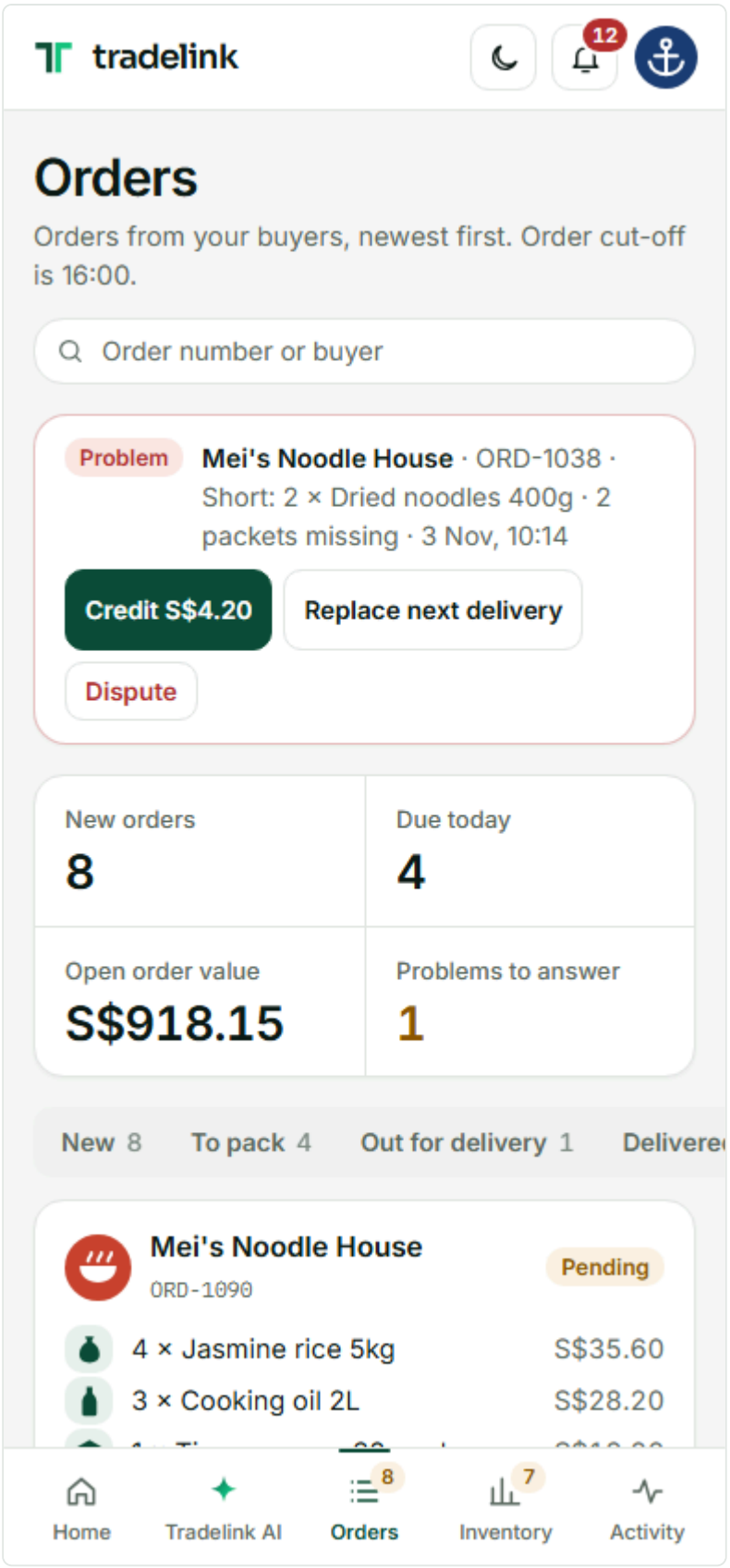


Figure 26. Orders on a phone.

Steps

1. Choose one:
    - **Accept order**: pick the delivery date and confirm.

- **Part accept**: under "How much can you send?", enter how many of each line you can send now. Under "What you cannot send now", choose **Not coming**, or **Send the rest on** and pick a date. Set the delivery date and select **Send part order**.
- **Reject order**: confirm that you cannot take it.

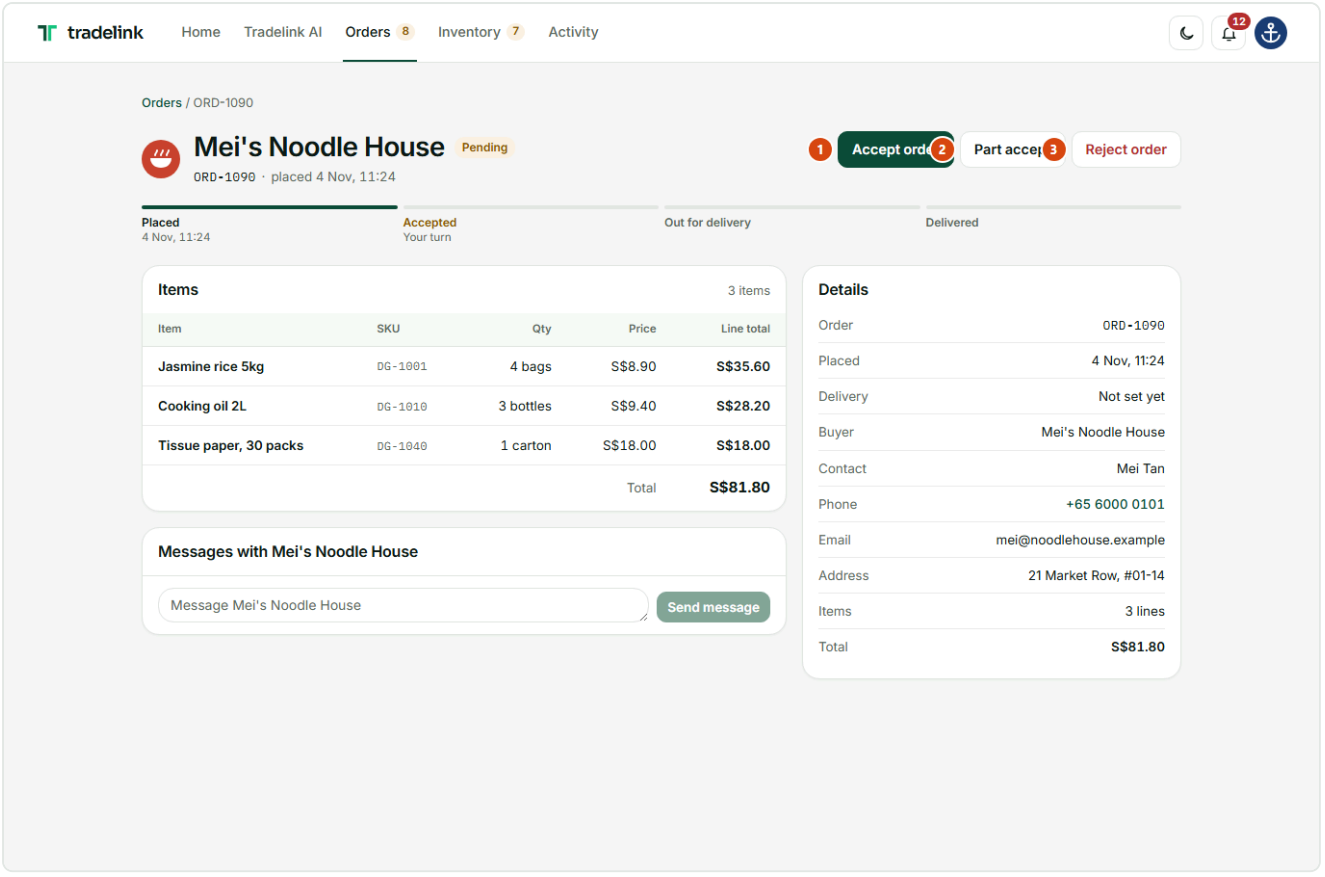


Figure 27. A new order. (1) Accept order. (2) Part accept. (3) Reject order.

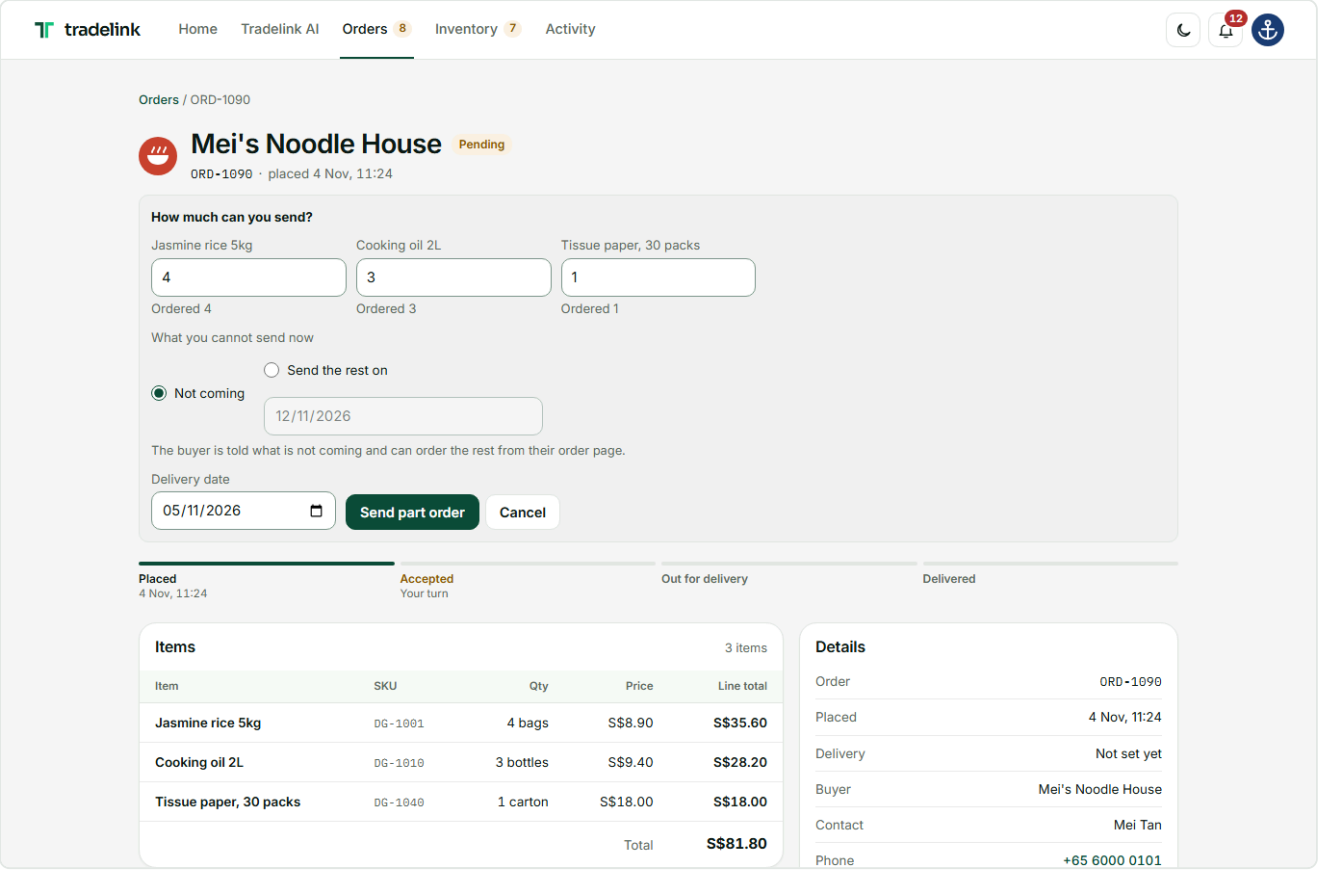


Figure 28. Part accept: how much you can send now, and what happens to the rest.

What happens next

- **Accept:** the buyer is told. The stock is held and the line prices are updated to your current prices.
- **Part accept:** the buyer is told what you will send. Stock you will not send now is released. If the rest comes later, the order shows a second delivery.
- **Reject:** the buyer is told, and any held stock is released.

Common problems

Message	What to do
"Confirm stock for the new products in this order first."	The order includes a product a buyer added. Confirm its price and stock in Inventory first (see 5.4).
"Check the highlighted lines..." or a stock warning	You do not have enough free stock. Part accept, or receive stock first.
The delivery date is refused	The date must be today or later.

5.3 Deliver an order

Steps

1. Open **Orders > To pack**, then the order.
2. Select **Mark out for delivery** when it leaves.
3. Select **Mark delivered** when it arrives.

4. For a second delivery, use **Mark the rest out for delivery** and **Deliver the rest**. Select **Cancel the rest** if it will not come.

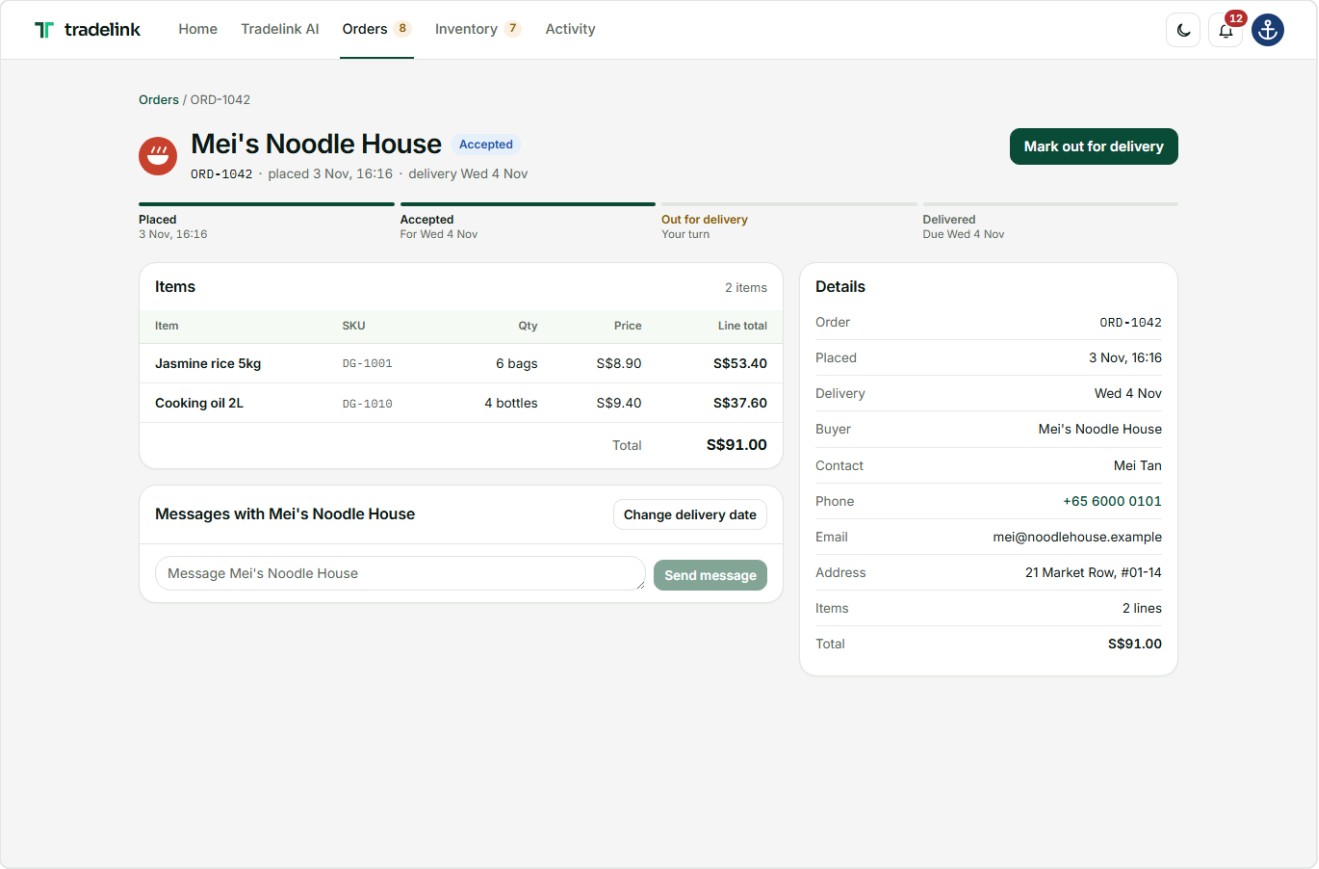


Figure 29. An accepted order, ready to go out.

What happens next: the buyer is told at each step. On delivery, the stock leaves your inventory, and the buyer is asked to check the delivery.

Messages and date changes: to message the buyer, use **Messages with *buyer*** on the order and select **Send message**. To ask to move a delivery date, select **Change delivery date**, pick the delivery and the **New date**, and select **Ask *buyer***; Tradelink AI can do the same. Requests from the buyer show on the order and in the alert with **Accept new date** and **Decline**.

Common problems

- **"There is not enough free stock for the rest yet. Receive stock first."** You need enough free stock for the second delivery.

5.4 Manage inventory

What this is for: keeping stock, prices and products up to date.

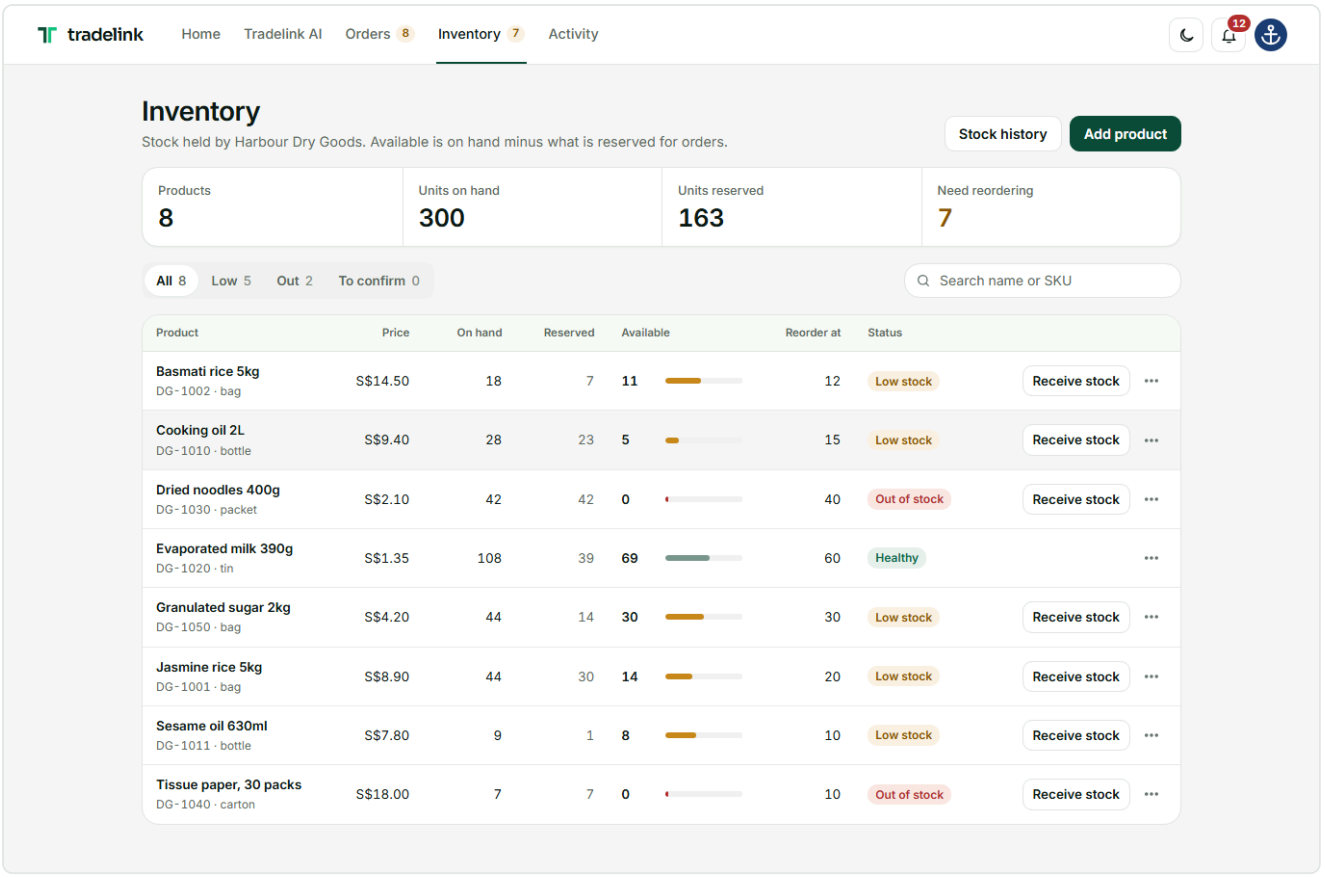


Figure 30. Inventory, with filters for Low, Out and To confirm.

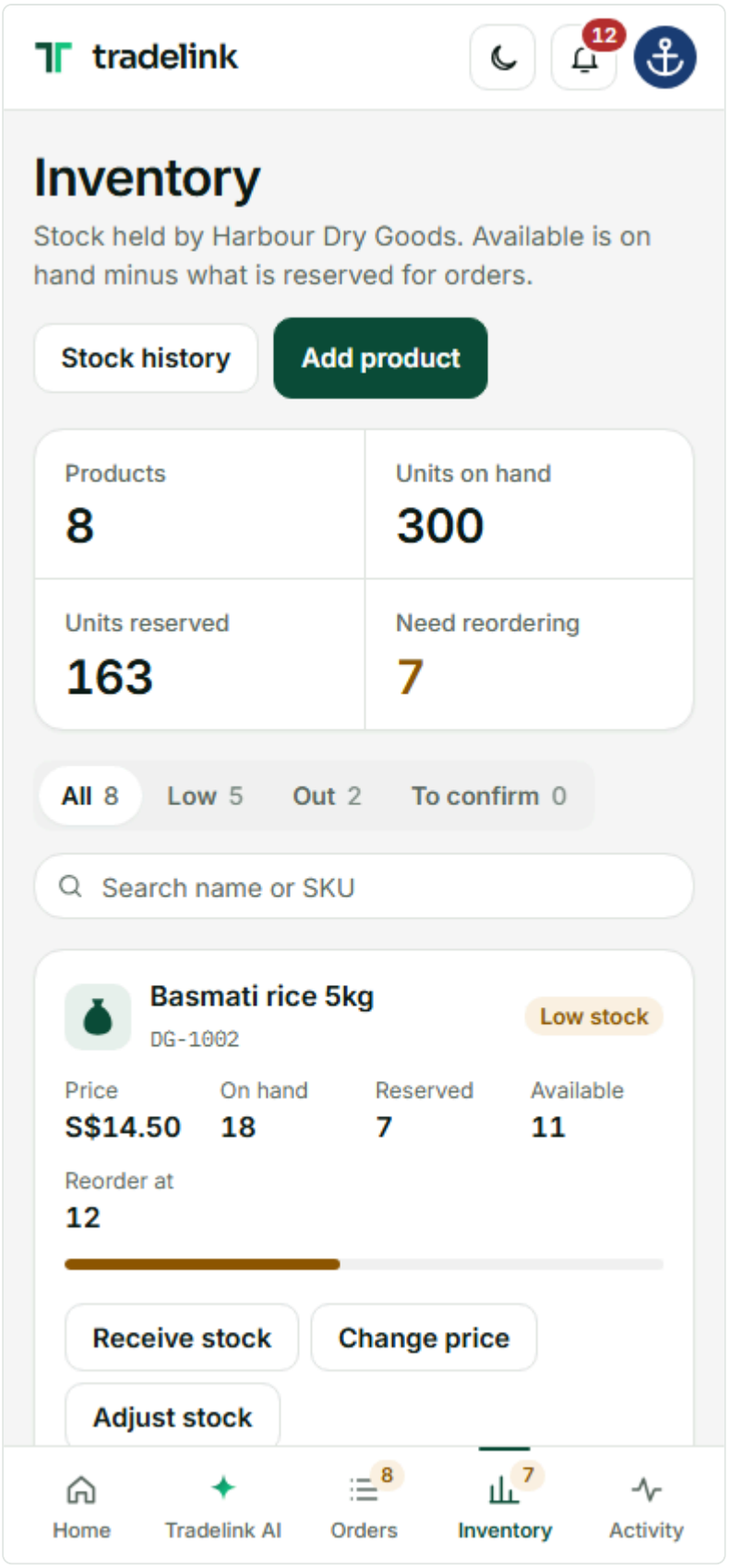


Figure 31. Inventory on a phone.

Task	Steps	What happens next
Add a product	Select **Add product**. Enter the name, unit, price, opening stock, reorder level and category. Save.	The product is listed for your buyers.

Task	Steps	What happens next
Receive stock	Select **Receive stock** on the product. Enter how many arrived (1 to 9999). Save.	The units are added. A product a buyer added becomes active.
Confirm a product a buyer added	Filter **To confirm**. Select **Confirm stock**. Enter the quantity, price and reorder level. Save.	The product becomes active, and waiting orders can be accepted.
Change a price	Select **Change price**. Enter the new price. Save.	Buyers see the change in their Prices list. Orders you accept after the change use the new price.
Adjust stock	Select **Adjust stock**. Enter the change, a reason (**Damaged**, **Expired** or **Count correction**) and a note if needed. Save.	The change is recorded in Stock history.

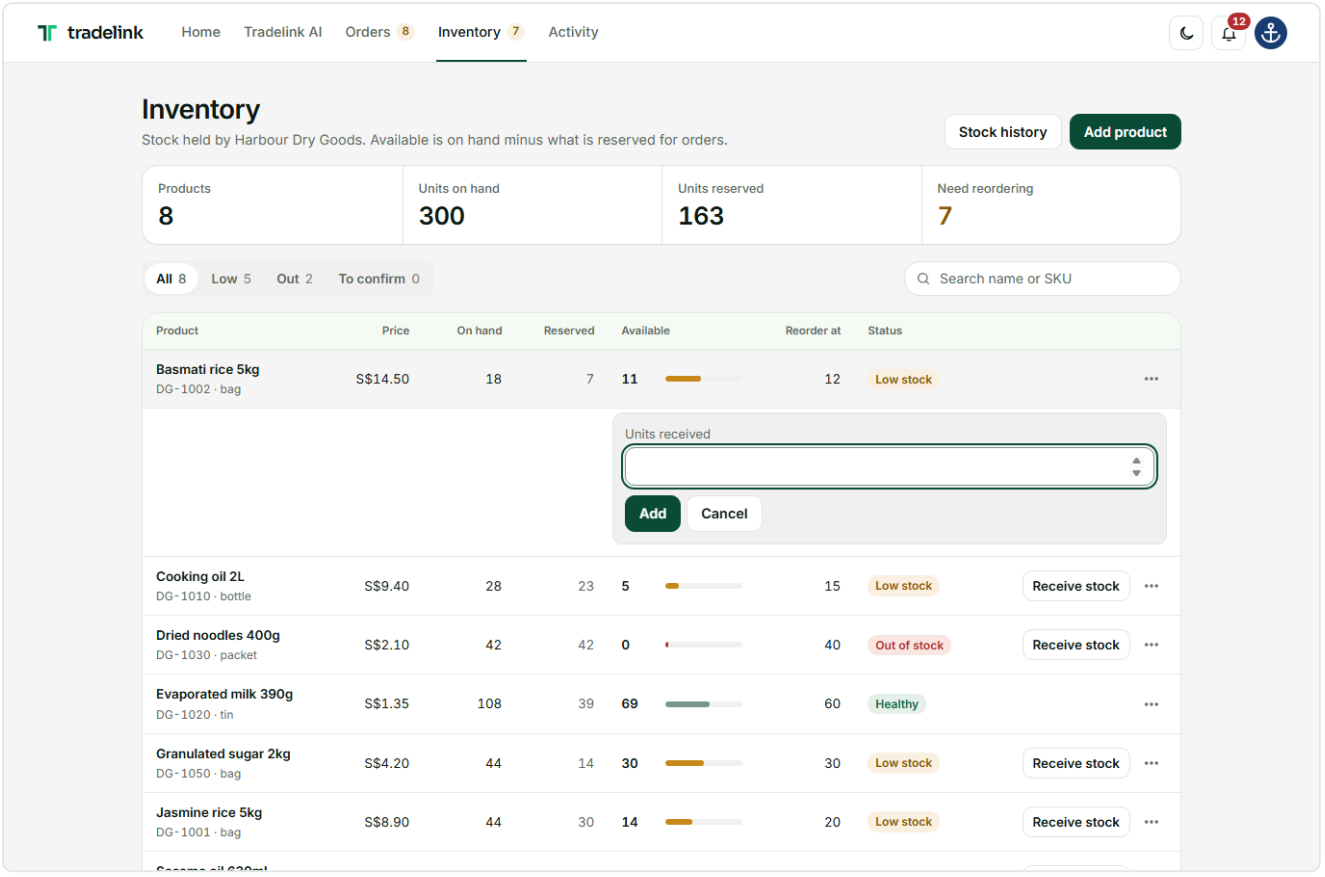


Figure 32. Receiving stock.

Common problems

- **"This leaves less stock than is reserved for open orders."** You cannot lower stock below what is already held for orders.

5.5 Answer problems

What this is for: settling a problem a buyer reported.

Steps

1. Open the order from the alert, or from Home > **Answer problems**. Go to the **Problems** section.
2. Choose an answer:
    - **Credit S$x**: promise a credit for the amount shown.
    - **Replace next delivery**: not available for late deliveries.
    - **It is on the way**: for late deliveries only.
    - **Dispute**: you disagree. The Tradelink team decides.

What happens next

- The buyer is told.
- A promised credit shows **Waiting for buyer to confirm** until the buyer confirms it arrived.
- A dispute goes to the Tradelink team's queue.

> **Not available yet:** invoice queries. The invoice problem type exists in the system, but buyers cannot raise one.

5.6 Activity, stock history and settings

- **Activity:** a feed of what happened to your orders, stock and account, grouped by day. Filter by order, stock or account.
- **Stock history:** every stock change (Received, Reserved, Released, Delivered, Adjusted), with the units after the change and the reason. It is under Inventory.
- **Settings:** your business profile: contact details, product range, lead time, order cut-off time, delivery days and minimum order. Account and Appearance are there too.

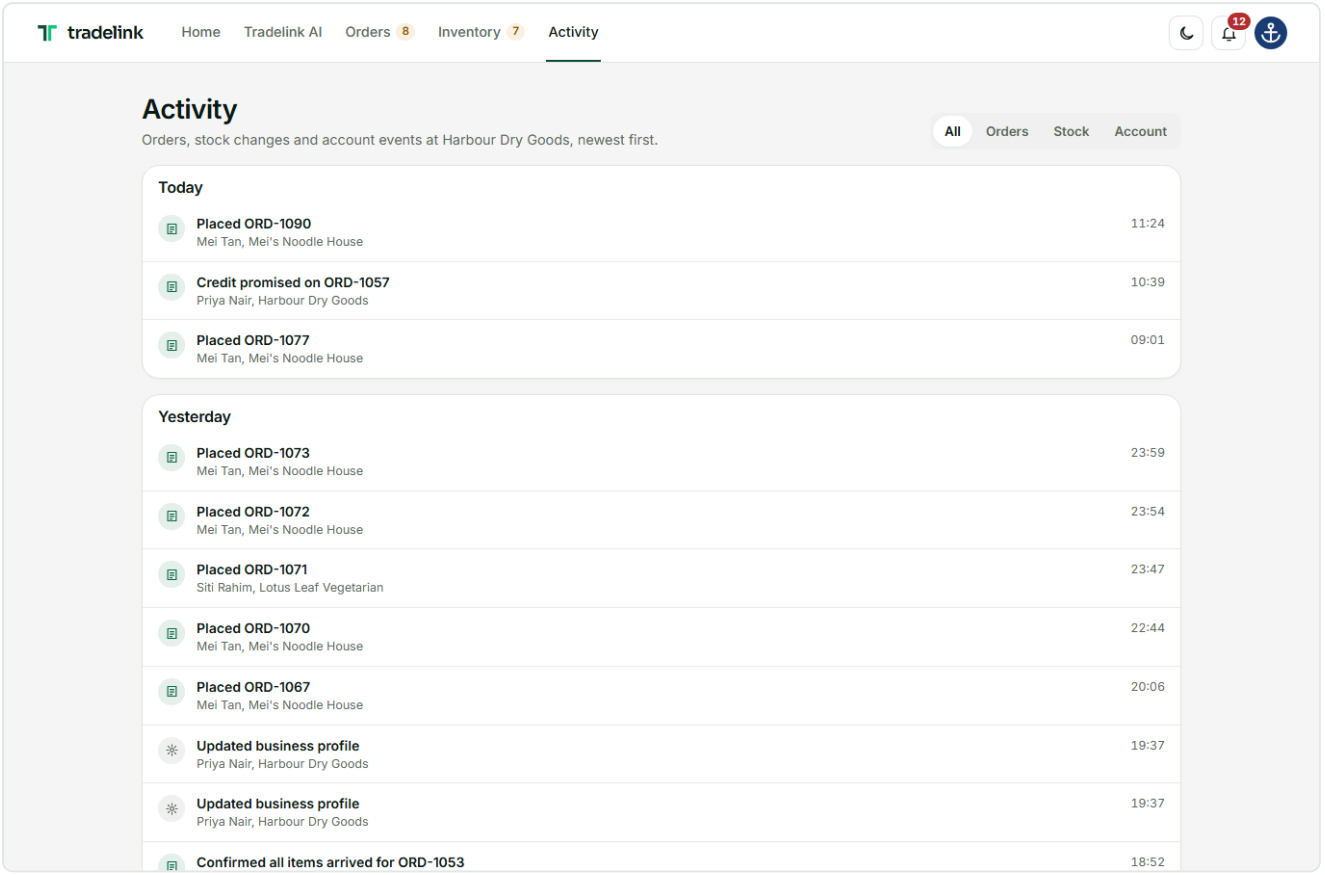


Figure 33. Activity.

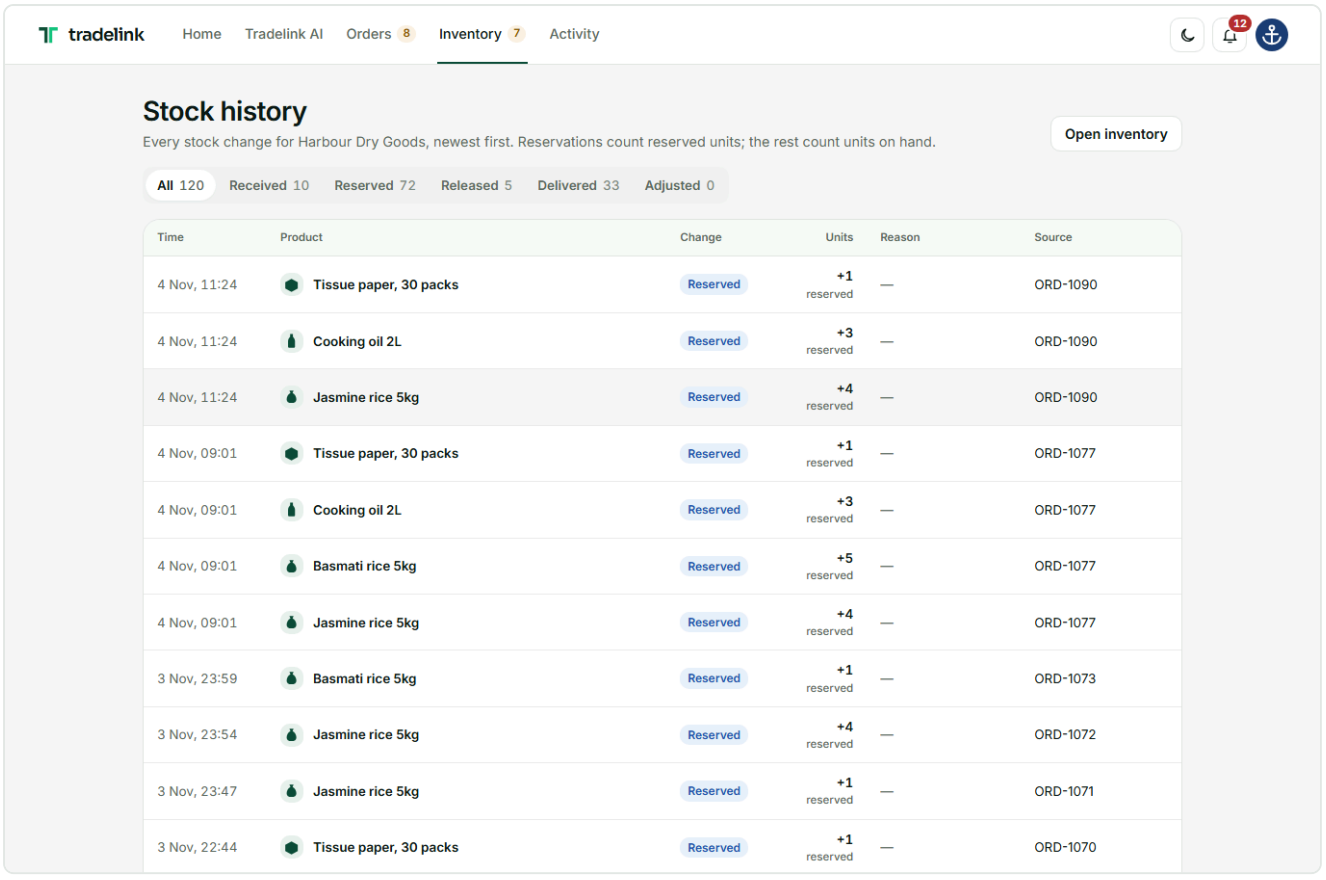


Figure 34. Stock history.

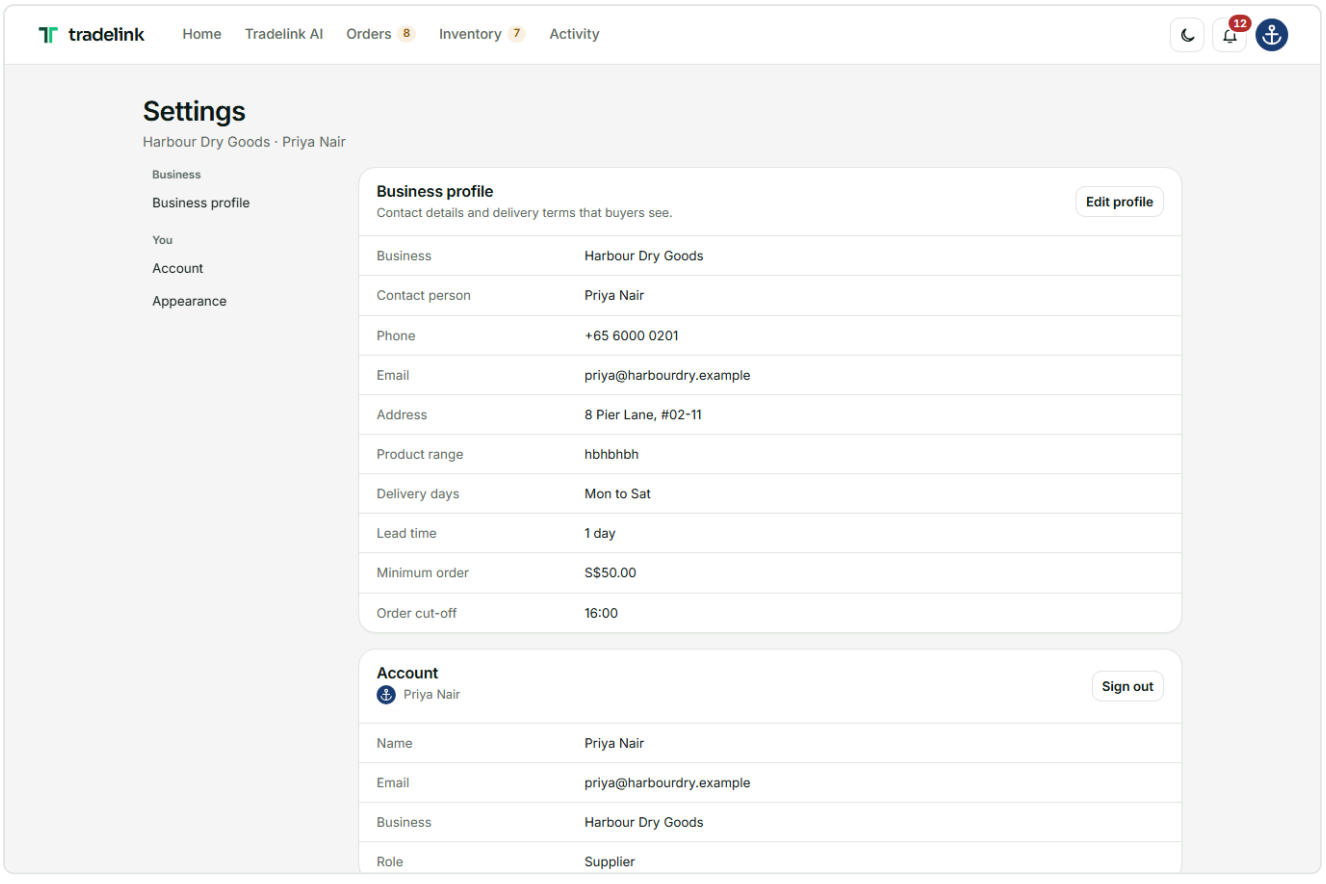


Figure 35. The business profile in Settings.

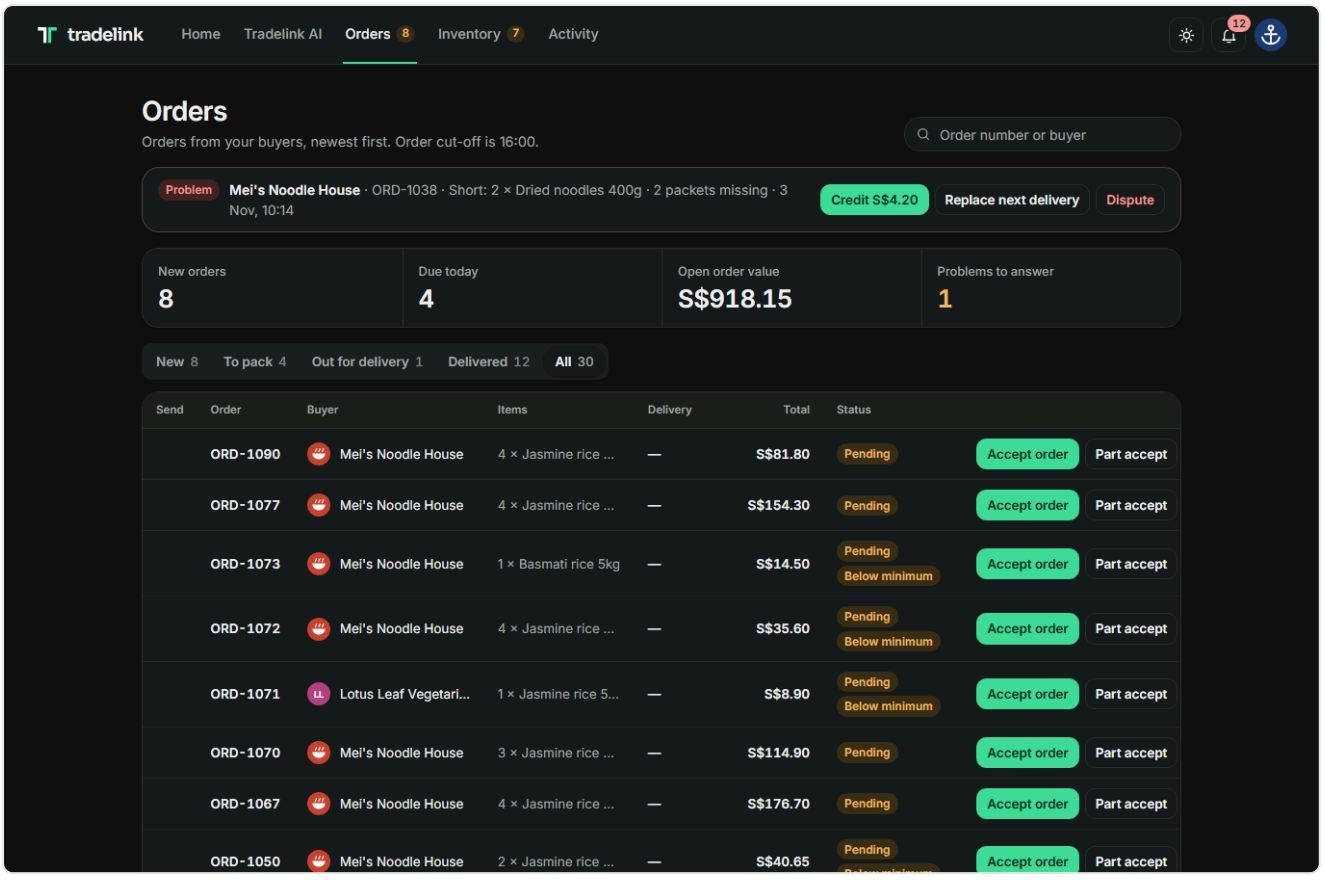


Figure 36. Supplier Orders in dark mode.

6. Admin guide

6.1 Understand Home

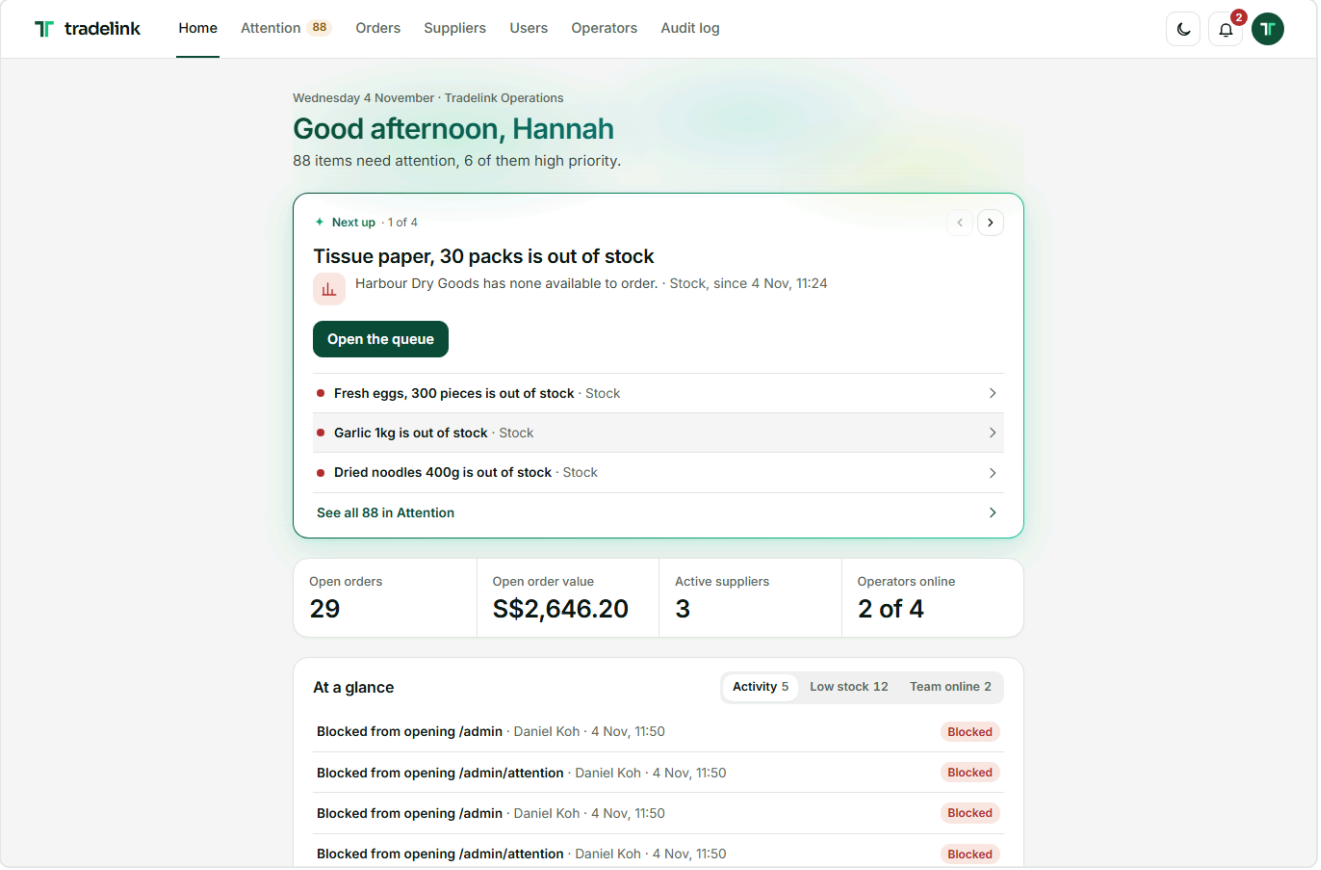


Figure 37. Admin Home.

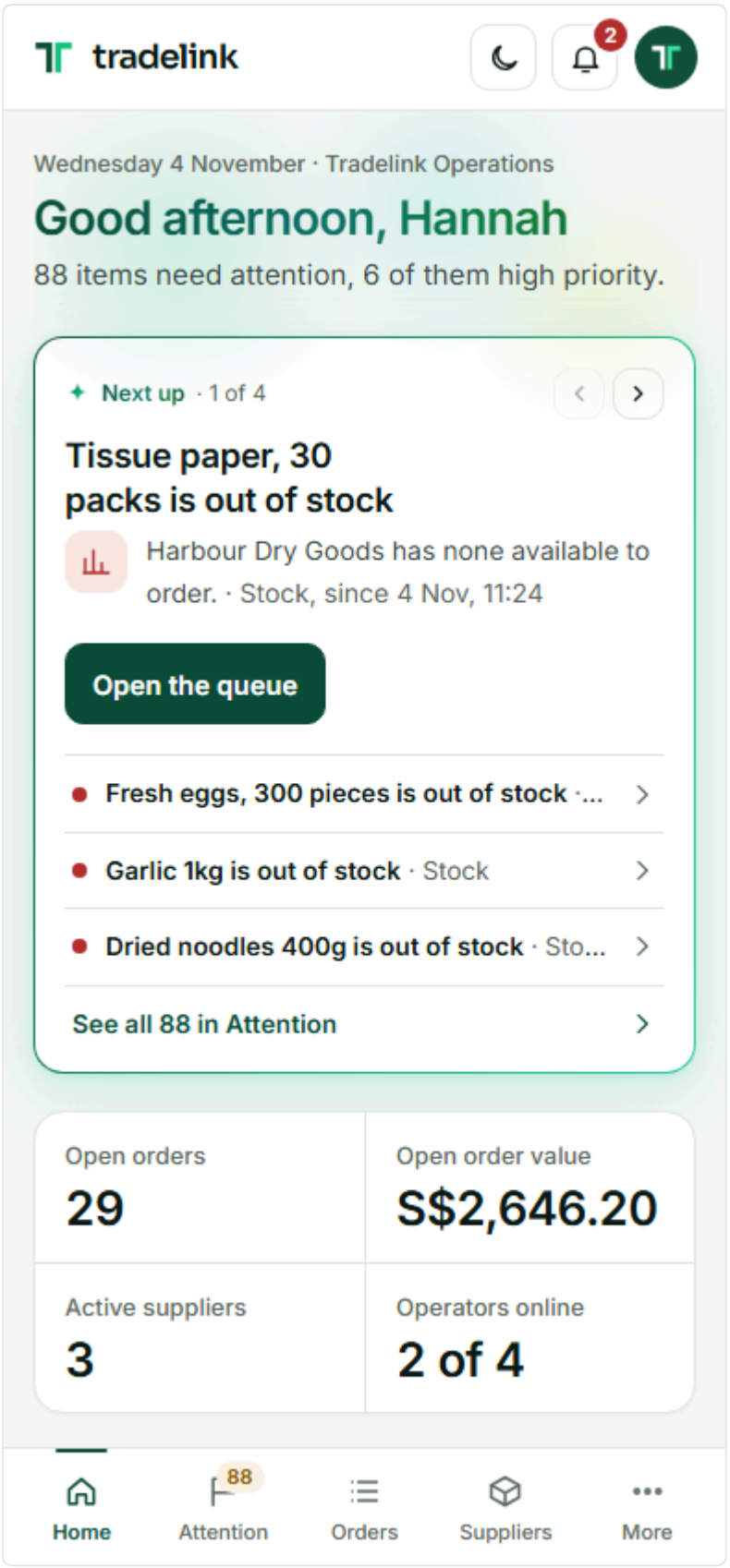


Figure 38. Admin Home on a phone.

Part of the page	What it shows
Summary line	How many items need attention, and how many are high priority. Operators see only items assigned to them.
Next up	The four newest urgent items, with **See all in Attention** for the rest
Tiles	Open orders, open order value, active suppliers and operators online
At a glance	**Activity**, **Low stock** and **Team online**

6.2 Work through Needs attention

What this is for: making sure nothing on the platform is left waiting.

Steps

1. Open **Attention**. Items are sorted with high priority first, then oldest first.
2. Use the filters: **All**, **High**, **Medium**, and **Unassigned** (operations lead only).
3. For each item, use its buttons:
    - **View supplier** opens the supplier involved.
    - **Open audit log** is shown for blocked actions.
    - **Mark handled** is shown for blocked actions.
    - **Credit buyer** and **Close, no credit** are shown for disputes (see 6.4).

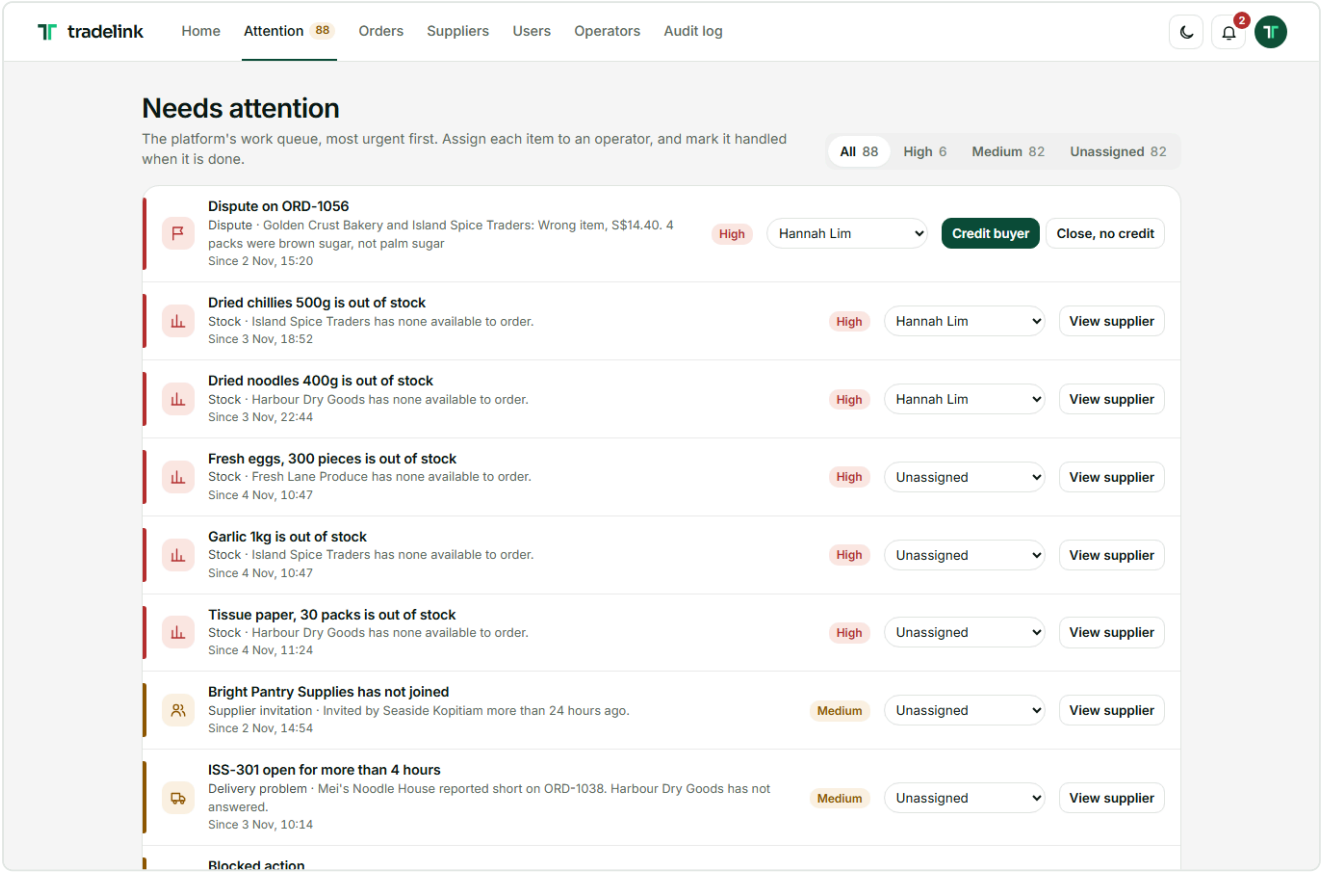


Figure 39. The attention queue, seen by the operations lead.

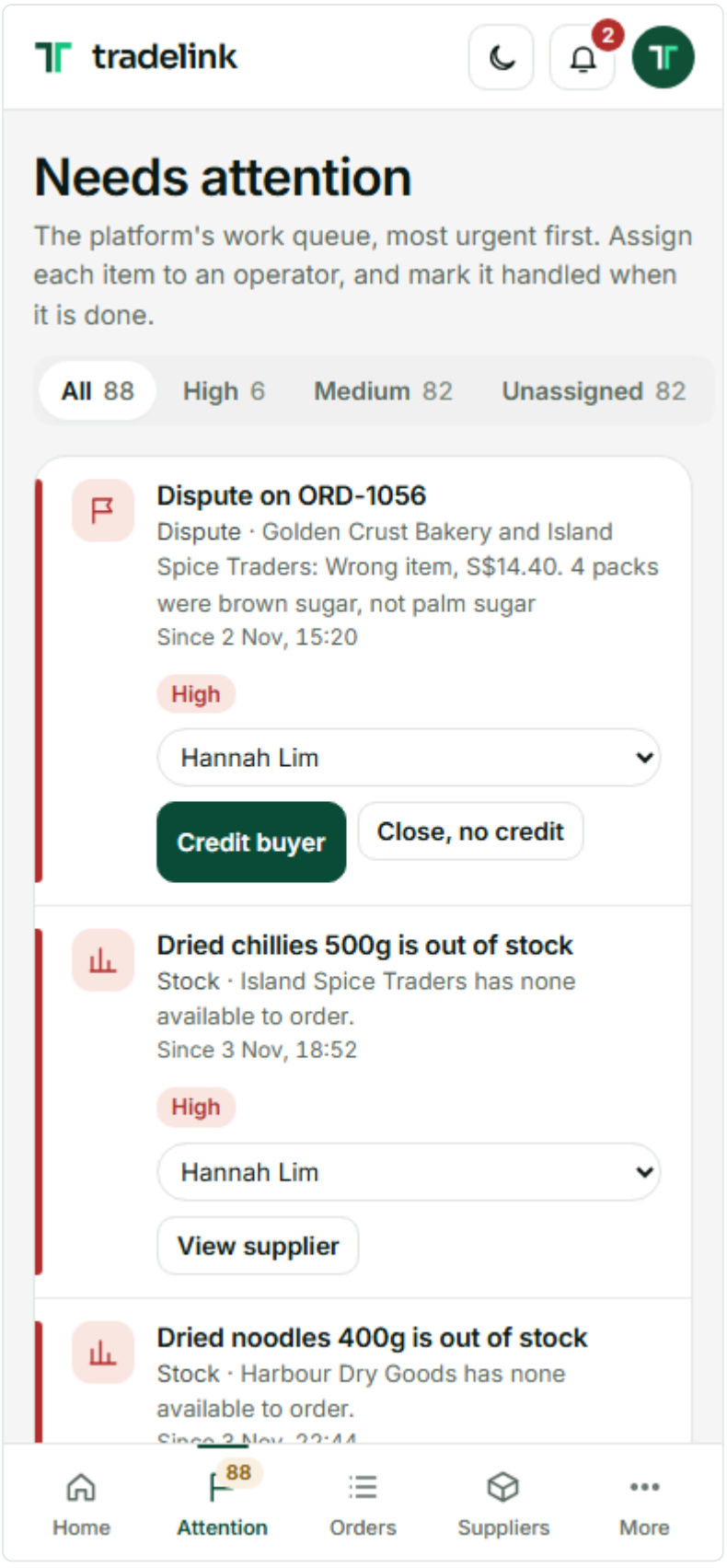


Figure 40. The attention queue on a phone.

What creates an item

Item	Priority	Appears when
Dispute	High	A supplier disputes a buyer's problem
Out of stock	High	An active product has no free stock
Delivery problem	Medium	A problem is unanswered for more than 4 hours
Order waiting	Medium	A supplier has not answered an order for more than 30 minutes
Product not confirmed	Medium	A buyer added a product and the supplier has not confirmed it
Running low	Medium	Free stock is at or below the reorder level
Supplier invitation	Medium	A supplier a buyer added has not joined after 24 hours
Blocked action	Medium	Someone tried something they are not allowed to do

What happens next: most items close by themselves when their cause is fixed, for example when stock arrives or the supplier answers. A blocked action stays until someone marks it handled.

6.3 Assign operators

What this is for: sharing out the queue so each item has an owner.

Before you start: only the **operations lead** can assign items. In the demo, this is Hannah.

Steps

1. In **Attention**, find the item.
2. In **Assigned to**, choose the operator. The choice saves straight away.

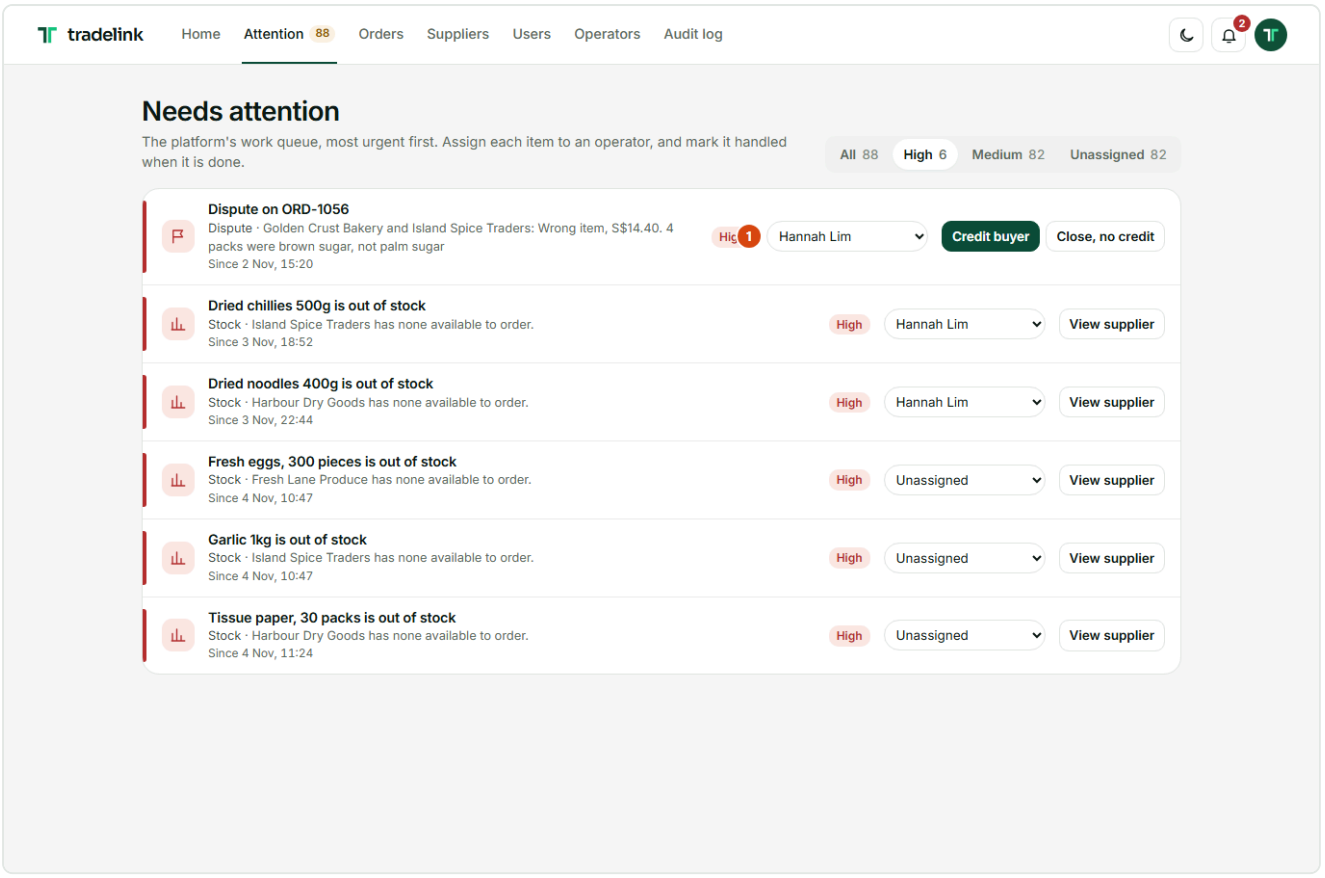


Figure 41. (1) Assigned to: the operations lead picks an operator.

What happens next: the item appears in that operator's queue and on their Home. Operators see only items assigned to them, marked **Assigned to you**.

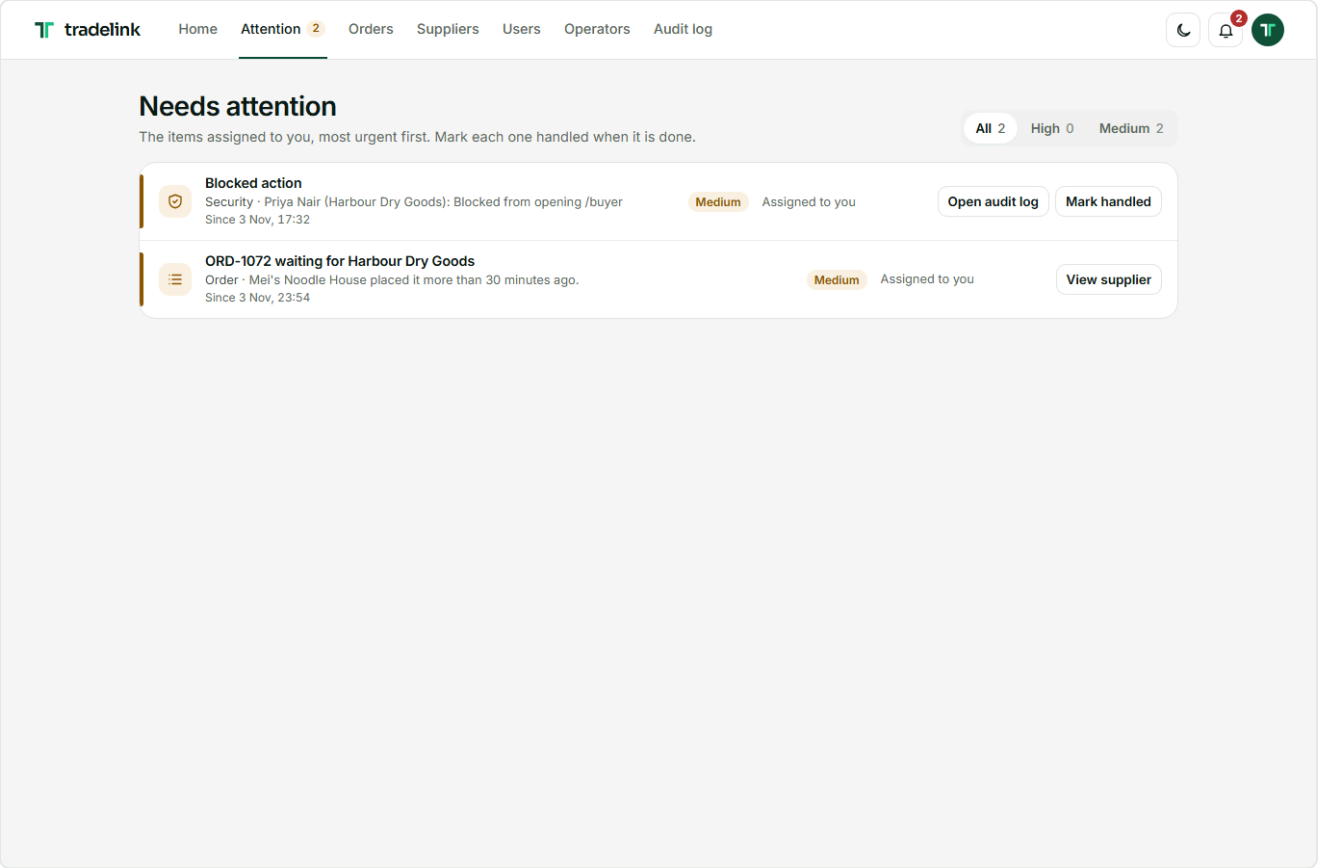


Figure 42. An operator sees only their own items.

Common problems

- **"This did not save. Reload the page and try again."** The page was open across an update of the app. Reload it.
- **The Assigned to choice is missing.** You are not the operations lead.

6.4 Manage disputes

What this is for: deciding a problem when the buyer and supplier disagree.

Steps

1. Open **Attention** and filter **High**. Disputes read "Dispute on ORD-*number*", with both businesses, the problem, the amount and the note.
2. Choose **Credit buyer** or **Close, no credit**.

What happens next: both businesses are told. **Credit buyer** asks the supplier for the credit, and the buyer confirms it when it arrives. **Close, no credit** ends the problem.

6.5 Suppliers, buyers, users and operators

Page	What you can do
Suppliers	Filter by **Active**, **Invited**, **Suspended** and **Declined**. Open a supplier to see its profile, products and orders. **Suspend** or **Reactivate** a supplier, with a confirm step. **Low stock** lists products at or below their reorder level.

Page	What you can do
Users	View buyers and all accounts, with search. Open a buyer to see its details and orders. View only.
Operators	View the team and who is online. The operations lead also sees how many items each operator has. View only.

Suspending a supplier: hides its products, stops new orders, and cancels its pending orders, releasing the stock. The supplier and its buyers are told. The supplier can still deliver orders already accepted.

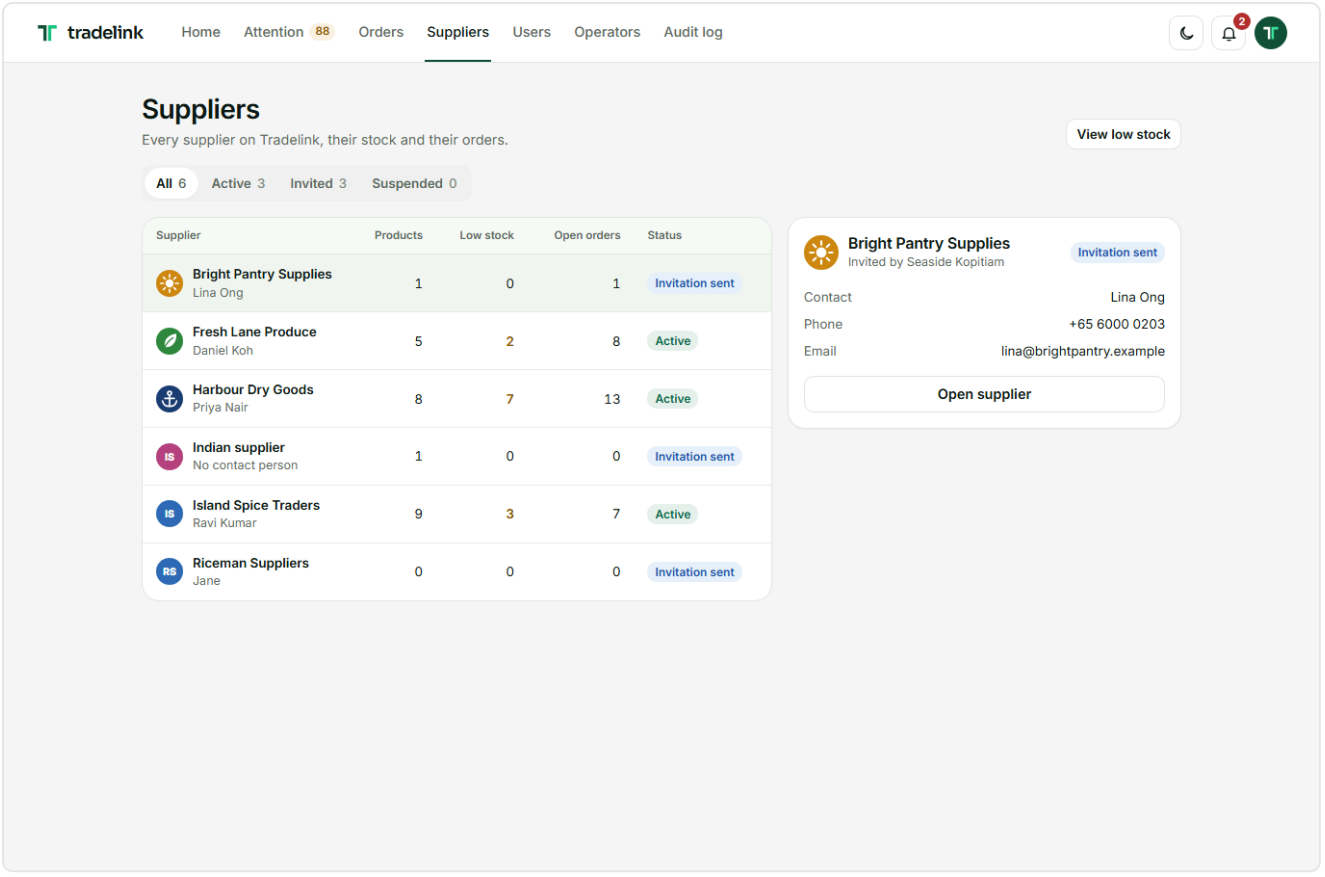


Figure 43. Suppliers.

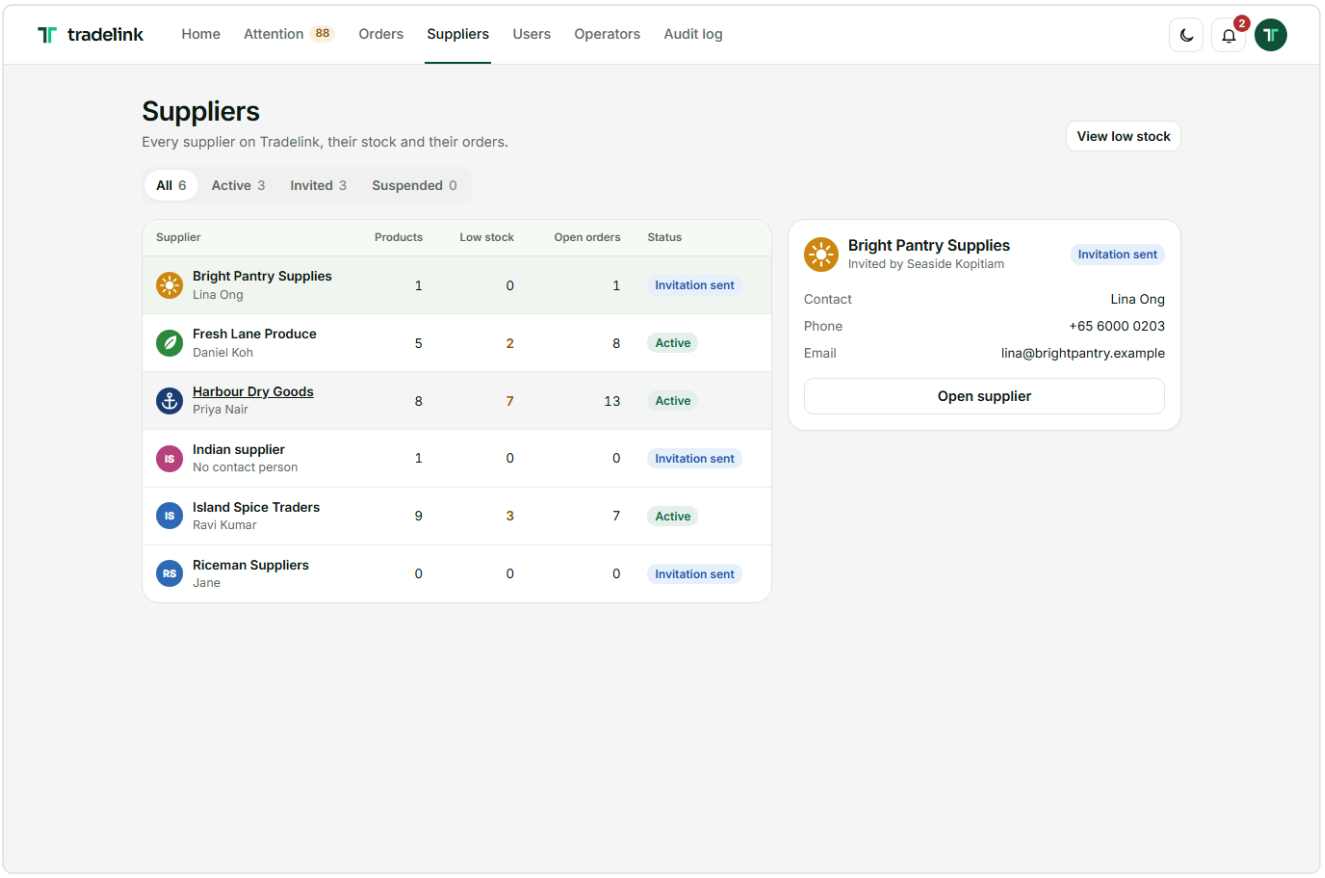


Figure 44. A supplier's details, with Suspend.

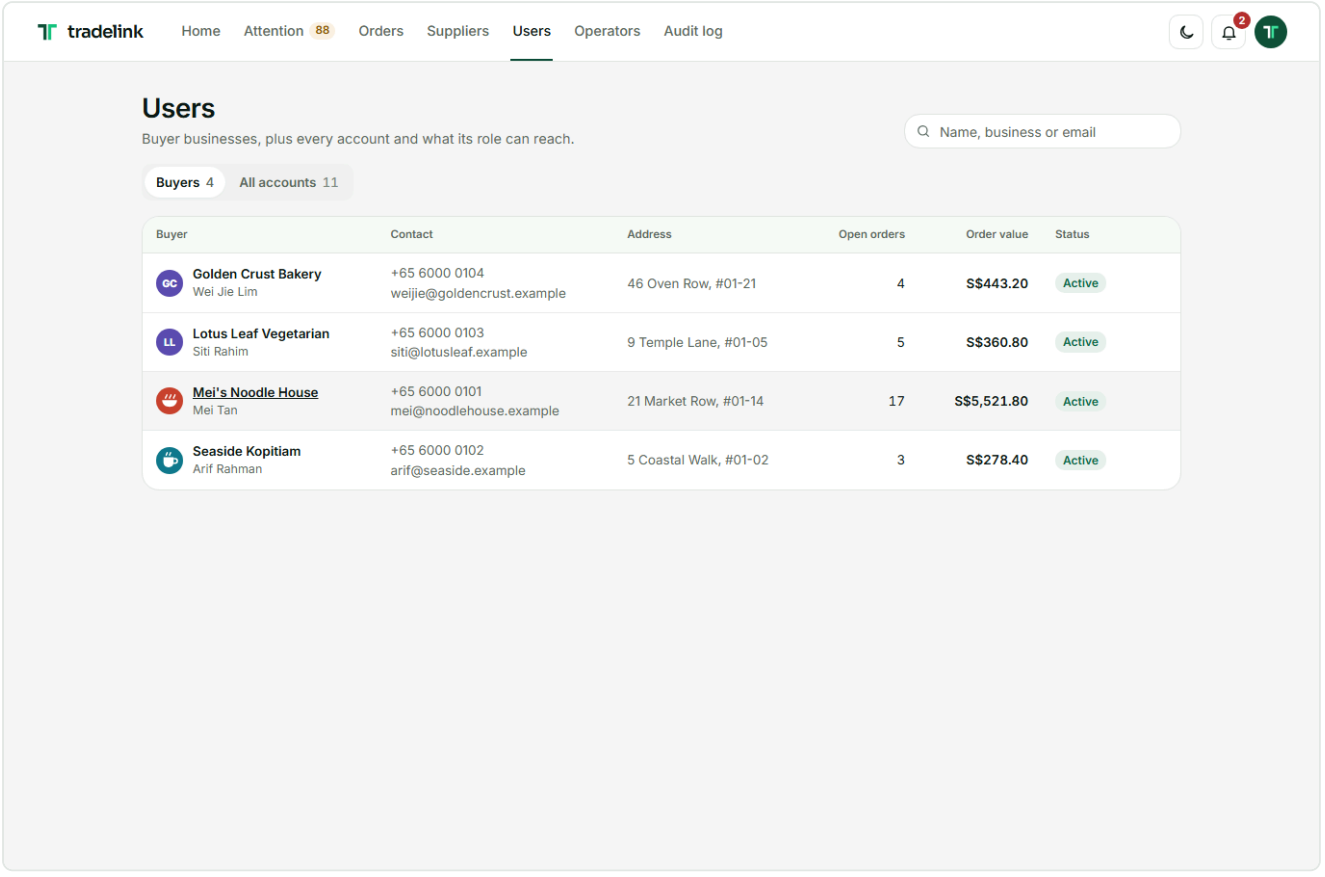


Figure 45. Users.

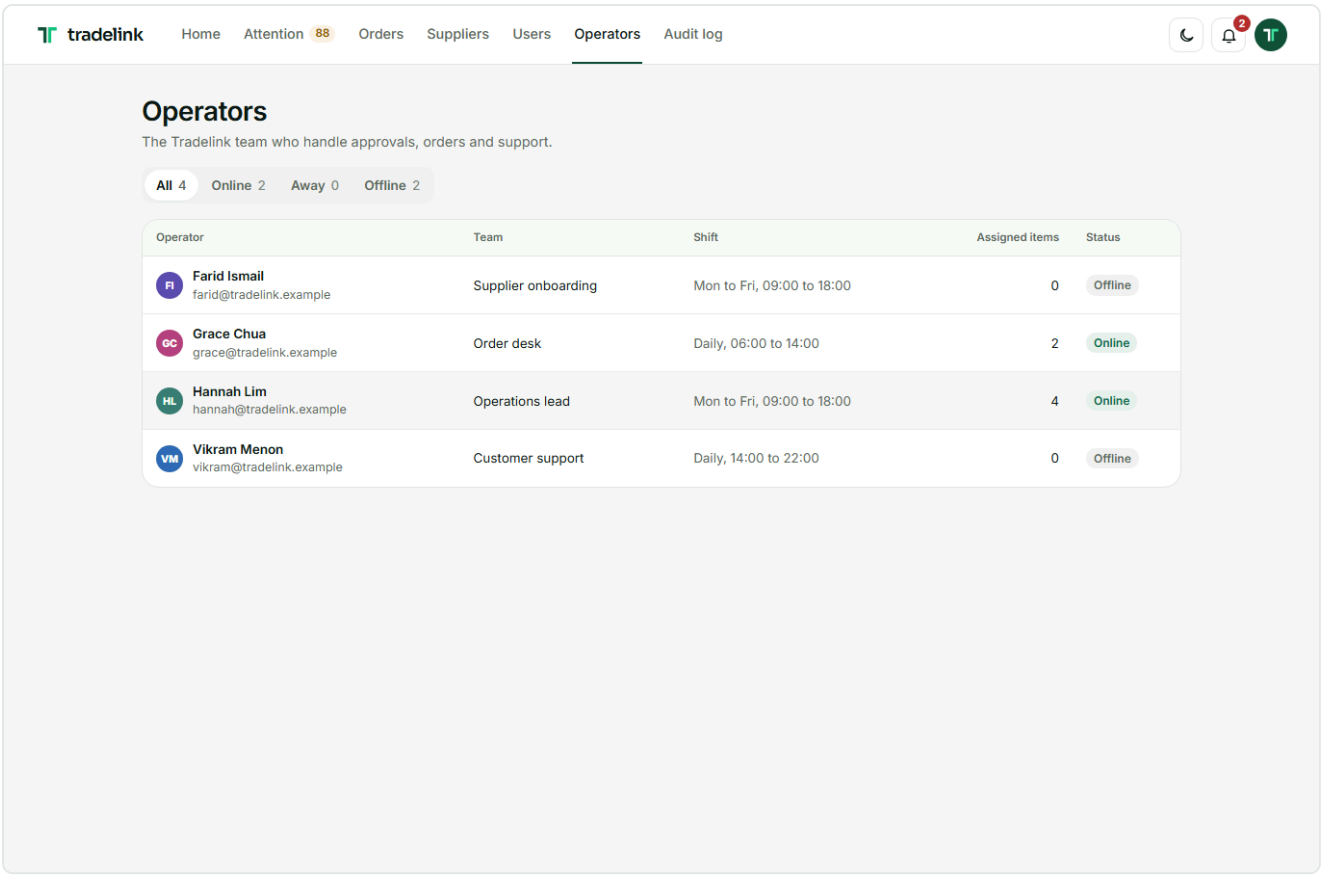


Figure 46. Operators.

> **Not available yet:** approving or declining suppliers, inviting people, and editing buyers, users or operators.

6.6 Notifications, all orders and the audit log

- **Notifications:** new accounts, disputes and security events.
- **Orders:** every order on the platform, with status filters and search by order number. View only.
- **Audit log:** every change, who made it and when, including blocked attempts. Filter by **Organisation** (the business whose person made the change) and **Outcome** (**Allowed** or **Blocked**). Entries cannot be edited or deleted.

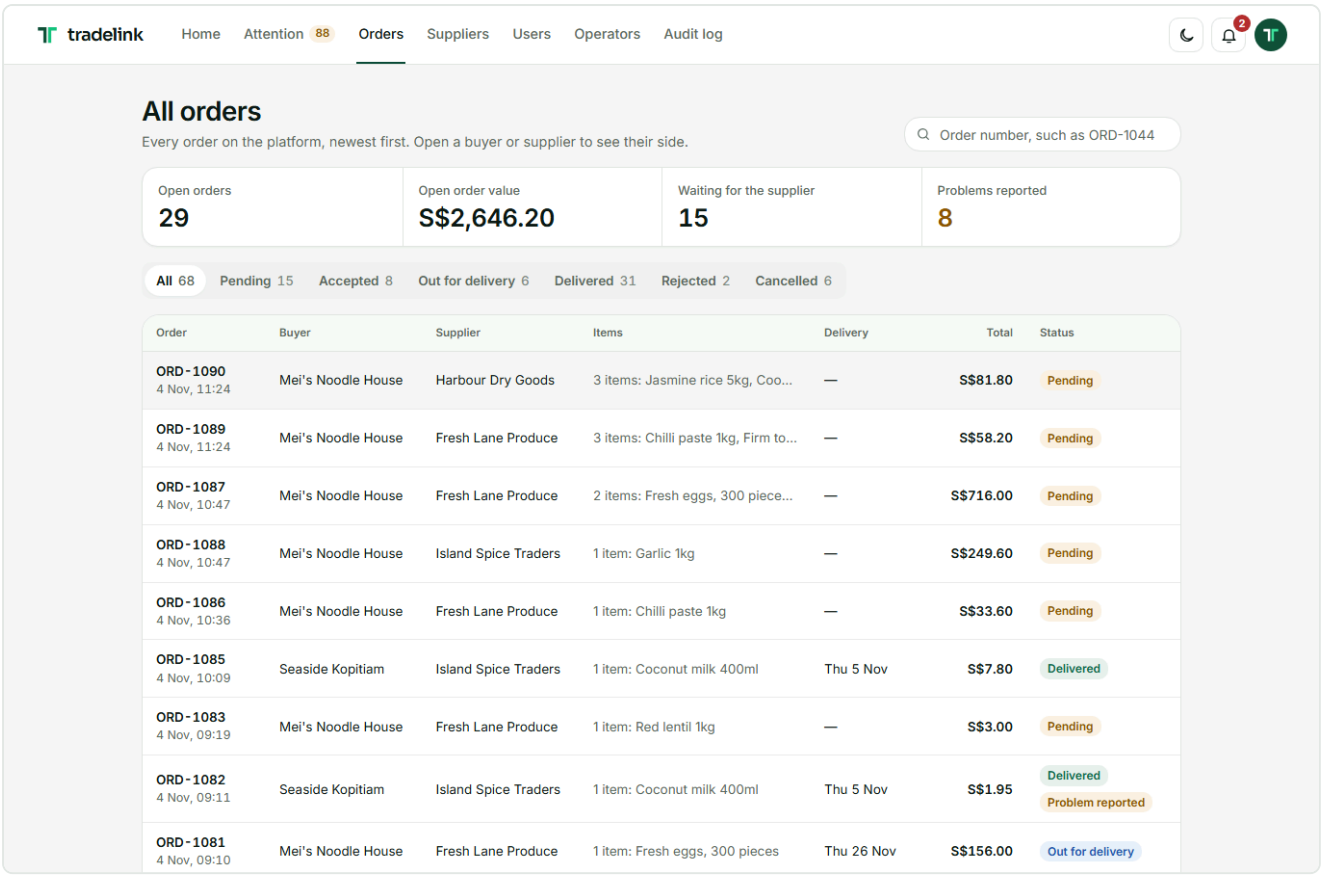


Figure 47. All orders.

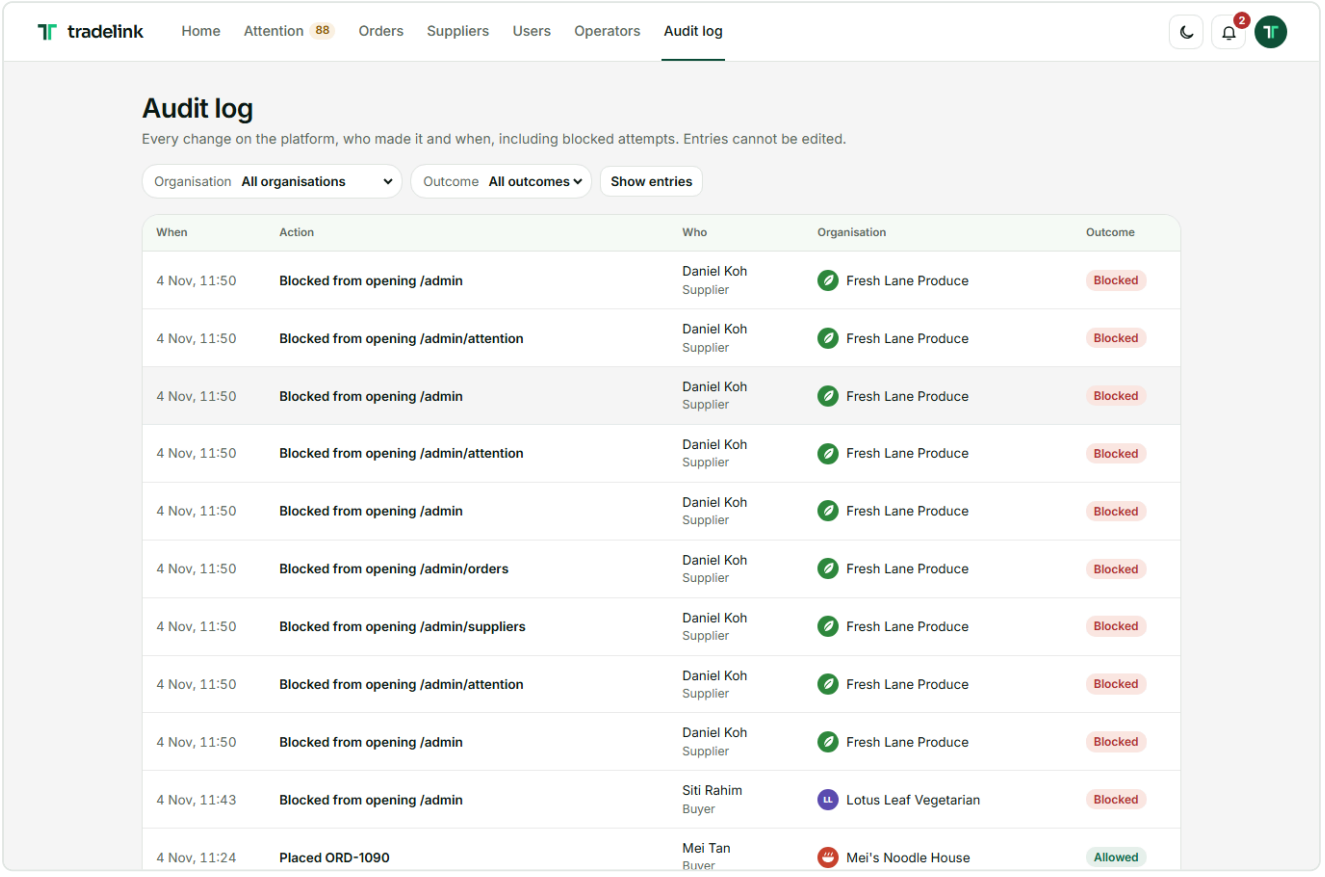


Figure 48. The audit log.

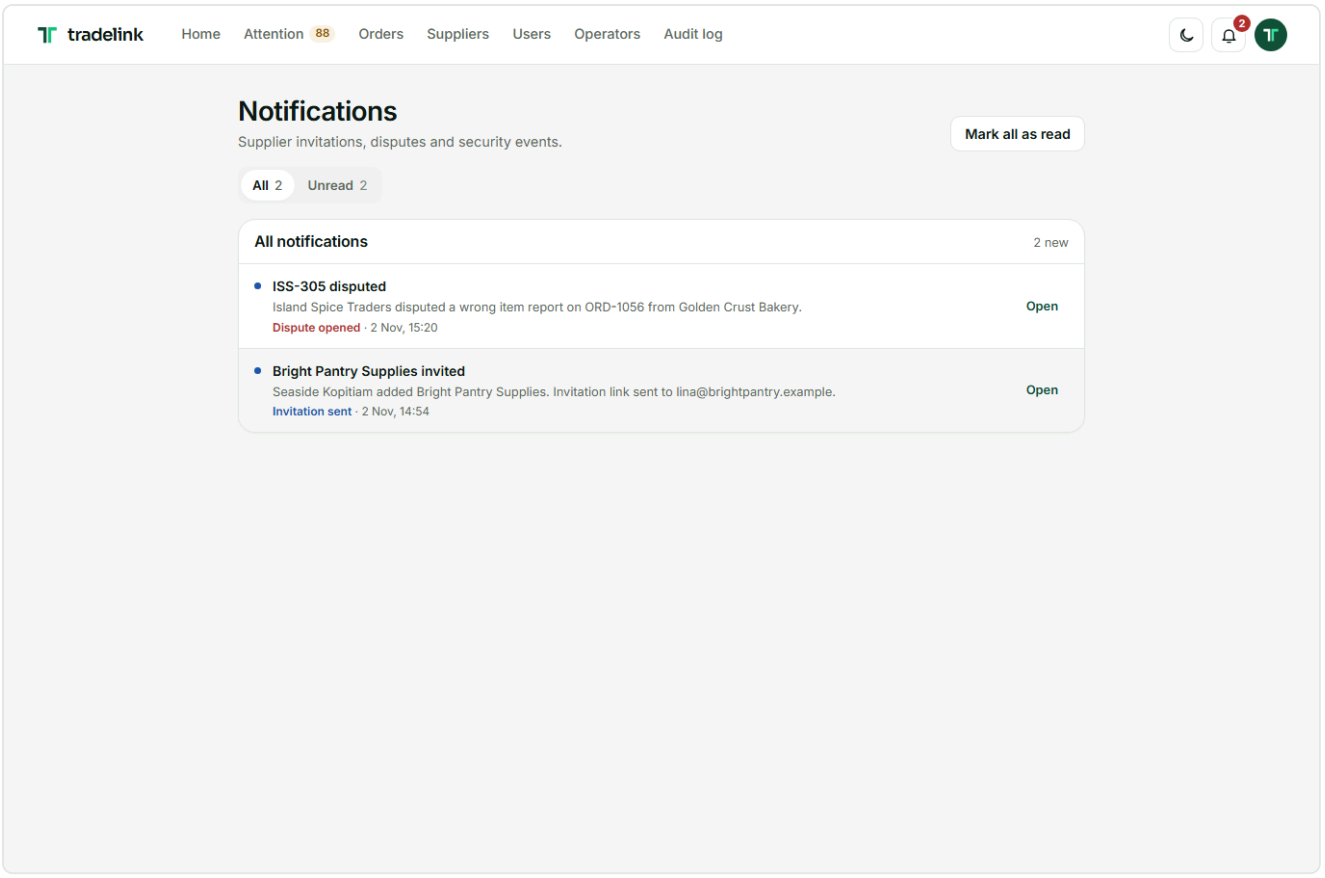


Figure 49. Admin notifications.

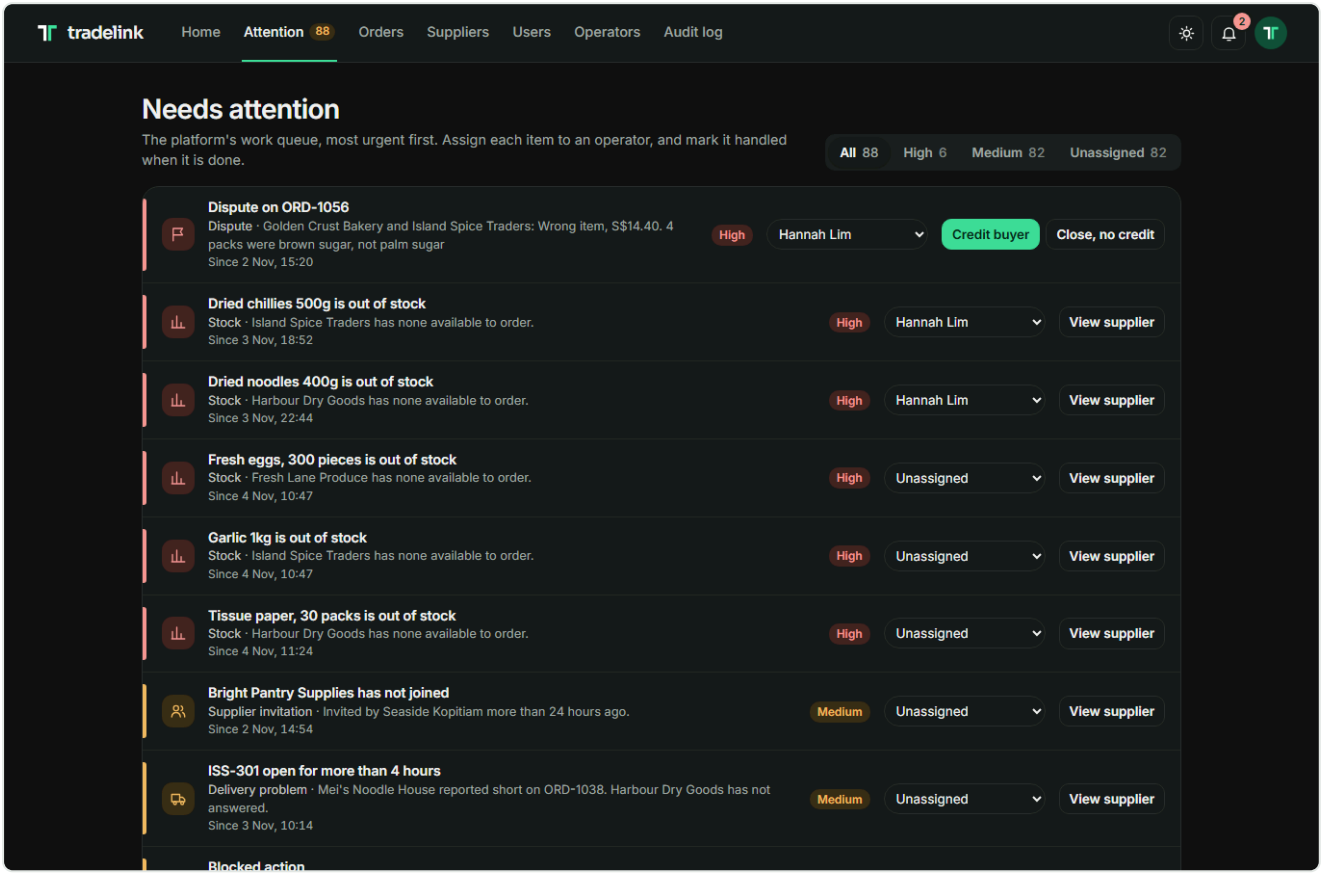


Figure 50. The attention queue in dark mode.

> **Not available yet:** a system status page.

7. Security and privacy tips

- **Keep your password to yourself.** Tradelink staff will never ask for it.
- **Use a long password.** At least 12 characters; a short phrase is easier to remember.
- **Sign out on shared devices.** Use the account menu > **Sign out**.
- **Check before you confirm.** Tradelink AI never changes anything until you tap its button. Read the card first.
- **Text you type is shared with the other business.** Problem notes and order messages are visible to them, so keep them to the order.
- **You only see your own business's data.** Buyers see their own orders and their suppliers' catalogues. Suppliers see orders sent to them. The Tradelink team sees what it needs to support you.
- **Every change is recorded.** The audit log keeps who did what and when, including blocked attempts.

8. Frequently asked questions

Question	Answer
Do I need to install anything?	No. Tradelink runs in your browser. You can add it to your home screen (see 2.4).
Can Tradelink AI place an order without asking me?	No. It always shows a card and waits for you to tap its button.
Why was my order sent although it is below the minimum?	The minimum is a guide. The order is marked **Below minimum** so both sides can see it.
When is stock held for me?	When you place the order. It is released if the supplier rejects it or you cancel it.
Can I change an order after placing it?	You can cancel it while it is waiting for the supplier. After that, message the supplier through Tradelink AI.
Why did my dark mode setting not follow me to my phone?	The setting is remembered per browser.
Does Tradelink handle invoices or payments?	No. Payments and invoices happen outside Tradelink. Credits for problems are tracked in the app.
Will I get emails or text messages?	Only sign-in emails, such as password resets. All other notifications are in the app.
A supplier I use is not on Tradelink.	Add them through Tradelink AI (see 4.6) and let them know yourself.

9. Troubleshooting

What you see	Why	What to do
"This page did not load"	Something went wrong loading the page	Select **Try again**. If it keeps happening, give the support team the code shown.
"This did not save. Reload the page and try again."	The page was open while the app was updated, or the connection dropped	Reload the page and repeat the step.
"Something went wrong. Try again."	An unexpected error	Try again in a moment.
An offline page	No internet connection	Reconnect and select **Try again**.
"Check the highlighted lines before placing this order."	Another order took the stock first	Lower the highlighted quantities, or remove those lines.
"This order changed in another tab. Check it again before confirming."	The cart was changed in another tab or device	Check the cart again, then place the order.
"Too many requests. Try again in a few minutes."	You sent many messages or requests in a short time	Wait a few minutes and try again.
"You do not have access to do that."	The action belongs to another role, or to the operations lead	Ask the right person, or the Tradelink team.
The bell count does not go down	Alerts are still unread	Open the bell panel and select **Mark all as read**.

10. Glossary

Term	Meaning
Buyer	A business that orders stock through Tradelink
Supplier	A business that sells to buyers through Tradelink
Admin, operator	A member of the Tradelink operations team
Operations lead	The admin who sees and assigns every attention item
Tradelink AI	The built-in assistant. It suggests and prepares actions; you confirm them.
Confirm card	The card Tradelink AI shows before it changes anything
Cart	Your draft order lines, grouped by supplier, before they are sent
Usual items	Products you reorder regularly, with your usual quantity and daily use
Held or reserved stock	Stock set aside for an order and not available to others
Minimum order	The order value a supplier prefers. Orders below it are marked, not blocked.
Part accept	A supplier accepting only some of an order, with the rest later or not at all
Second delivery, "the rest"	The part of an order a supplier sends on a later date
Problem	Something wrong with a delivery: short, damaged, wrong item, expired or late
Credit	Money the supplier agrees to take off what the buyer owes

Term	Meaning
Dispute	A supplier disagreeing with a problem. The Tradelink team decides.
Needs attention	The admin work queue
Audit log	The permanent record of every change and blocked attempt

11. Document history

Version	Date	Author	Change
1.0	4 November 2026	Janya Mali, drafted with Claude	First version, written from the running app and its code